Anatomy of a Smooth Transition: A Task-Based Macroeconomic Model of AGI Displacement with Fiscal and Social Safety Nets

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Abstract

Artificial general intelligence (AGI) differs from automation in that it enters the creation of new tasks itself, so the engine that historically reinstated displaced labor may collapse endogenously. We build a task-based model with two-layer task structure in which the human reinstatement rate declines as AI capability advances, plus nominal rigidity, the zero lower bound and debt-deflation, capital-tax financing of workfare and transfers, and an independent social-instability channel. The high-employment equilibrium reaches and crosses the switching manifold through a persistence-type boundary equilibrium bifurcation of the piecewise-smooth fast subsystem, continuing as a stable low-employment equilibrium on the other side; we derive a closed-form critical reinstatement rate, make it endogenous to workfare and retraining, and characterize with geometric singular perturbation theory the finite-rate lag between slow policy and fast employment. Three magnitudes are anchored to U.S. data; the rest are declared settings. Under these settings, the loss-minimizing policy on the reported grid is a workfare-dominant corner financed by a minimal capital tax, whereas no-policy and pure-transfer regimes are infeasible. The minimizer is grid-dependent rather than identified; we report the corner retaining a buffer. At the baseline frontier growth $g_A = 0.010$, consumption stays above the floor $C^{min} = 0.30$ with $\min_t C_t = 0.357$, and the financed buffer still holds at $g_A = 0.05$ ($\min_t C_t = 0.344$); the floor is breached only at $g_A = 0.10$ ($\min_t C_t = 0.294$), after which the path crashes, whereas fiscal parameters are nearly inert. Frontier-growth shocks (σ up to 0.03) produce no economic crash across 200 paths of the reported corner, and the fifth percentile of minimum consumption stays at 0.355,

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although a fraction of paths no longer reach the employment target. The model-implied message: a smooth transition requires a financed buffer whose sufficiency is conditional on frontier speed. *JEL classification:* E24, E31, E62, J64, O33.

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1. Introduction

Artificial general intelligence (AGI) and large-scale automation portend a fundamental reallocation of work. Task-based analyses of recent automation show that new-task creation has historically reinstated labor displaced by machinery (Acemoglu–Restrepo) [2], but the AGI setting is different in kind: AGI participates in *new-task creation itself*, so the reinstatement engine may collapse endogenously. The recent AGI macroeconomics literature splits into two poles. On the *supply side*, Restrepo (2025) [27] and Korinek–Suh (2024) [20] characterize conditions under which automation collapses wages: when the complexity of tasks humans can perform is bounded and full automation is reached, or when automation outruns capital accumulation. On the *demand side*, Fornaro–Wolf (2026) [14] stress that automation shifts income from high-MPC workers to savers, weakening aggregate demand and lowering the natural rate. Yet these two poles remain disconnected, and neither connects wage collapse to the *transitional fiscal policy* needed to sustain demand while the labor share vanishes.

This paper proposes a task-based macroeconomic model that closes these gaps in a single, numerically solvable switching system. Its ingredients are: a two-layer task model (production and creative tasks) in which the reinstatement engine collapses endogenously as AGI participation κ_N^{AI} dominates human new-task creation; a demand side with nominal rigidity, the zero lower bound, and debt-deflation; a fiscal closure in which a capital tax finances workfare (public employment) and transfers under a balanced-budget constraint; and a social-instability channel independent of economic deflation, in which a large purely-relief population generates social pressure. The central methodological challenge is that feasibility here is a question not about a single equilibrium but about whether the high-employment branch still exists: in a piecewise-smooth switching system with a slow fiscal layer and a fast employment layer, no local linearization can answer it, so the transition has to be posed as a

bifurcation problem.

Our analytical results are six. We prove that reinstatement collapse drives the labor share monotonically to zero with no self-correcting mechanism, and that skill-retention value is proportional to the reinstatement rate ω, vanishing as $\omega \to 0$ (Theorem 1). We upgrade Fornaro–Wolf's demand shortfall into an explicit, decidable deflationary spiral (Theorem 4), cascading the wage-collapse source into crash dynamics. We establish the existence of a smooth-transition region and a Laffer interior capital tax τ^* (Propositions 6–7), and show public employment strictly dominates transfers within a given budget because $1 > \mu_{TM}$ (Proposition 8). We prove that workfare has a structural protective advantage over a pure unemployment transfer against social-instability risk (Proposition 9), and establish a robustness ceiling for the entire buffer family: beyond a critical shock intensity, no combination of workfare and transfers can prevent an economic crash, so strong shocks require supply-side structural measures (Proposition 10).

Beyond these switching-system results, we develop an analytic bifurcation theory that makes the collapse mechanism itself tractable (Section 4). Deriving the fast subsystem directly from the model, we show that its vector field is quadratic and that the high-employment branch reaches and crosses the switching manifold through a persistence-type boundary equilibrium bifurcation, continuing as a stable low-employment branch on the other side; we derive a closed-form critical reinstatement rate and then make that rate endogenous to public employment, workfare and retraining, so that a sufficiently strong policy which retains skill can carry the effective capture across the time-varying threshold, and use geometric singular perturbation theory to characterize the finite-rate lag of the fast employment variable.

We anchor three magnitudes to U.S. data—the consumption floor, the transfer MPC $\mu_{TM} = 0.50$, and the workfare wage ratio—set the remaining entries by explicit convention, including the capital-tax growth inhibition $\eta = 0.40$, and run the full battery of experiments under a unified engine (Section 5). The six analytical results P1–P6 are reproduced within the reported grid; the minimum-loss point on the grid is a corner solution (workfare-dominant, transfers closed, minimal sufficient capital tax) whose coordinates are grid-dependent rather than identified, and, within this calibrated model at the baseline frontier growth $g_A = 0.010$, no-policy and pure-transfer regimes are infeasible because they violate the financing constraint,

while the smooth outcome itself is conditional on g_A: it is lost once g_A reaches 0.10 (Section 5). No parameter is estimated here, and none of the critical values is presented as one: the reinstatement rate at which the high-employment branch is lost, and the interior workfare share p_E^*, are dimensionless outputs of the calibrated model, so the paper claims structural insight rather than external identification. The central message, read as a model-implied rather than a universal claim, is that a smooth AGI transition *requires a policy buffer, and that buffer must be financed*.

The remainder of the paper is organized as follows. Section 2 lays out the model. Section 3 derives the analytical propositions. Section 4 develops the analytic boundary equilibrium bifurcation theory. Section 5 presents the calibration and the numerical evidence. Section 6 situates the contributions relative to the literature, and Section 7 concludes.

2. The Model

2.1. Environment

Discrete time $t = 0, 1, \ldots, T$. A continuum of labor $L^S = \bar{L} = 1$ is supplied inelastically and the wage is the numéraire, $w = 1$. Three agents populate the economy: firms that produce with a task technology; a government that taxes capital income and runs transfers / public employment; and households that consume, save, and supply labor. This is a deterministic switching system of aggregate difference equations (neither a DSGE nor an agent-based model) with no stochastic shocks along the baseline path (Table 1 adds a frontier-growth shock ensemble as a robustness check); all state variables are deterministic time-indexed arrays.

The state variables are the automation threshold I_t, the upper bound of new tasks N_t, the labor-task share $n_t \equiv N_t - I_t$, employment L_t^D, the labor share of employment $s_t \equiv L_t^D/\bar{L}$ (called the labor share throughout; it equals the wage-bill share $w_t L_t^D/Y_t$ only while $w\bar{L} = Y_t$), the price level P_t, nominal debt D_t, real debt $b_t \equiv D_t/P_t$, a skill stock σ_t, and a social-pressure index ς_t.

2.2. Technology: a two-layer task model with an endogenously collapsing reinstatement engine

We extend the Acemoglu–Restrepo task framework to two layers: a production-task layer and a creative-task layer that can itself be automated.

Automation (displacement) frontier.

$$\mathrm{d}I_t^{auto,g} = \kappa_I \, A_t, \qquad A_t = A_0(1+g_A)^t. \tag{1}$$

Reinstatement (new-task creation) engine.

$$\mathrm{d}N_t = \kappa_N^h \, S_t^h + \kappa_N^{AI} \, A_t \, M_0, \qquad S_t^h = S_0 \max\{0,\, 1 - \lambda_h \, I_{t-1}/N_{t-1}\}, \tag{2}$$

where S_t^h is creative labor still performed by humans and κ_N^{AI} governs AGI participation in new-task creation. The reinstatement engine *collapses endogenously*: when $\kappa_N^{AI} \gg \kappa_N^h$, the locus of new-task creation switches from humans to compute.

Task allocation and closed accounting. Each period's new tasks $\mathrm{d}N_t$ are split between labor and AI by the labor capture efficiency $\eta_t^{cap} = \omega \, \sigma_{t-1}$: labor captures $\eta_t^{cap} \, \mathrm{d}N_t$ and AI captures the remainder $(1 - \eta_t^{cap}) \, \mathrm{d}N_t$. The realized direct automation is capped by the labor tasks available, $\mathrm{d}I_t^{auto} = \min\{\, \mathrm{d}I_t^{auto,g},\, n_{t-1} + \eta_t^{cap} \, \mathrm{d}N_t\}$. The automated stock and labor tasks then obey

$$\mathrm{d}I_t = (1 - \eta_t^{cap}) \, \mathrm{d}N_t + \, \mathrm{d}I_t^{auto}, \qquad \mathrm{d}n_t = \, \mathrm{d}N_t - \, \mathrm{d}I_t = \eta_t^{cap} \, \mathrm{d}N_t - \, \mathrm{d}I_t^{auto}, \tag{3}$$

so the identity $n_t = N_t - I_t$ holds exactly in every period, with $n_t \geq 0$; no independent update of n_t is used. Here $\omega \in (0, 1]$ is the *reinstatement rate*, the share of new tasks accruing to labor, held exogenous here and endogenized in Section 4, and σ_{t-1} is the skill stock. **Key modelling choice**: the value of skills is proportional to ω. When $\omega \to 0$ (AGI takes over new-task creation, so new tasks no longer accrue to labor), skills have no economic return even at arbitrarily high levels. This mechanizes Restrepo's (2025) proposition that skills no longer determine wages.

Employment and the labor share.

$$L_t^D = \bar{L} \cdot \min\{1,\, \max\{0,\, n_t/N_t\}\}, \qquad s_t = L_t^D/\bar{L}. \tag{4}$$

Skill stock (retraining vs. public employment).

$$\sigma_t = \sigma_{t-1}\Big(1 - \delta_\sigma \, \tfrac{U_t^{rem}}{\bar{L}} \, \big(1 - \rho_{ret} \, \beta_{ret}\big)\Big), \qquad \sigma_t \geq \underline{\sigma} = 0.30. \tag{5}$$

Skills are preserved only by retraining $\rho_{ret} \in [0,1]$; $\beta_{ret} \in [0,1]$ scales how effectively retraining offsets skill decay, and public employment (workfare) does not preserve skills.

Output.

$$Y_t = (1+g_{eff})^t \left(1 + g_{disp}\,\delta_{disp}\right), \qquad g_{eff} = g_G(1-\eta\tau), \qquad \delta_{disp} = (I_t - I_0)/N_0, \tag{6}$$

where g_{eff} embeds the Laffer-style supply-side cost of the capital tax τ.

Capital income (tax base) and taxation.

$$\Pi_t = \max\{0,\ Y_t - w_{t-1}L_t^D\}, \qquad \text{tax}_t = \tau\,\Pi_t. \tag{7}$$

2.3. Demand side: nominal rigidity, the zero lower bound, and debt-deflation

Wage rule (empirical, not a market-clearing condition):

$$w_t = \max\{\underline{w},\ w_{t-1}\,(1 + g_W - \lambda_w\,u_t)\}, \qquad u_t = 1 - s_t. \tag{8}$$

Inflation from the consumption gap.

$$\pi_t = \max\{\pi^{lb},\ \gamma_p\,(C_{t-1}/C^{fe} - 1)\}, \qquad P_t = P_{t-1}(1+\pi_t), \qquad C^{fe} \equiv w\,\bar{L}. \tag{9}$$

Nominal interest and the zero lower bound (ZLB).

$$i_t = \max\{0,\ r_n + \pi_t\}, \qquad r_t^d = i_t - \pi_t. \tag{10}$$

Balance-sheet-consistent household: a joint consumption–debt decision. The household makes one intertemporal choice over consumption and debt rather than choosing consumption first and accumulating residual debt. The disposable real flow in period t is

$$Y_t^d = w_t L_t^D + w^P E_t^P + \mu_{TM} TM_t - \mu_d \max\{0, r_t^d\}, \tag{11}$$

where $w^P E_t^P$ are public-employment wages and $\mu_{TM} TM_t$ are transfers subject to a leakage $\mu_{TM} \in (0,1)$. The stock carried into the period after interest is $D_t^{roll} = D_{t-1}(1+i_t)$. The household then chooses a single net flow, borrowing against an unfunded consumption gap at rate θ and amortizing the debt in excess of the target $\bar{b}$ at rate χ:

$$\Delta D_t^{des} = \theta \max\{0, C^{fe} - Y_t^d\} - \chi \max\{0, D_t^{roll} - \bar{b}P_t\}. \tag{12}$$

Banks supply credit against a hard underwriting ceiling b^{credit} on the debt burden, a genuine stock constraint rather than a consumption cut-off:

$$D_t = \text{clip}\Big(D_t^{roll} + \Delta D_t^{des},\, 0,\, b^{credit} P_t\Big), \qquad \Delta D_t = D_t - D_t^{roll}, \qquad b_t = D_t/P_t. \tag{13}$$

Consumption is the residual of the disposable flow and the realized net borrowing, with no separate truncation:

$$C_t = \max\{0,\, Y_t^d + \Delta D_t/P_t\}. \tag{14}$$

The consumption drag of deleveraging is therefore identical to the real net repayment that actually reduces D, so no demand is suppressed by a term that leaves the stock unchanged. There is no ad hoc cap on the debt burden and no consumption truncation: the only bounds are the bank ceiling b^{credit}, which binds the stock, and the zero floor. Debt-deflation remains active because $b_t = D_t/P_t$ rises when P_t falls, but the endogenous amortization χ and the credit ceiling keep D_t finite, replacing the earlier specification in which a monotone stock with no repayment and no credit supply could diverge. The parameters are $\theta = 0.10$, $\chi = 0.15$, $\bar{b} = 0.35$, and $b^{credit} = 0.80$.

2.4. Fiscal closure: the transition financing gap

Policy response (with delay d):

$$\phi_t = \min\{\phi^{\max},\ \phi^{base} + \rho_{resp}\, u_{t-d}\}. \tag{15}$$

Planned spending.

$$E_t^{plan} = w^P E_t^P + \phi_t\, w\, U_t^{rem}, \qquad E_t^P = \min\{p_E\, u_t \bar{L},\ u_t \bar{L}\}, \qquad U_t^{rem} = u_t \bar{L} - E_t^P. \tag{16}$$

Balanced budget / fiscal feasibility:

$$\text{actual spending} = \min\{E_t^{plan},\ \text{tax}_{t-1}\}, \quad \text{shortfall} \Rightarrow \text{proportional scaling } \rho = \text{tax}_{t-1}/E_t^{plan}. \tag{17}$$

Appropriations in period t are funded by taxes already collected in $t-1$: the government budgets against last period's realized revenue, so the fiscal constraint uses tax_{t-1} rather than the current-period tax. This is a within-period rule with no fiscal reserve account: surpluses are not carried forward and deficits are not rolled into debt, so the fiscal account is separate

from the household consumption debt D_t. When revenue is insufficient, spending is scaled down proportionally rather than borrowed. A financing-constraint collapse occurs when the scaled spending is too small to fund the floor, consumption falls below the subsistence level, and the economy crashes.

Naming the transfer. The transfer $\phi_t w U_t^{rem}$ is paid only to the unemployed remainder U_t^{rem}, is conditional on joblessness and bounded by the ceiling $\phi^{\max}$. It is therefore an unemployment transfer rather than a universal basic income: a UBI would be paid unconditionally to the whole population, including the employed, which this model does not implement. We use "unemployment transfer" (and "pure transfer" for the $p_E = 0$ limit) throughout and reserve "UBI" for the external policy literature.

2.5. Social instability (an independent failure channel)

$$\varsigma_t = \alpha_s \, (U_t^{rem}/\bar{L}). \tag{18}$$

The larger the purely-relief population (smaller p_E), the larger the social pressure. If $\varsigma_t > \varsigma^{th}$ for J consecutive periods, a *social-instability collapse* occurs. Public employment converts relief recipients into dignified jobs, reducing pressure. This is the mechanism behind "workfare $>$ pure transfer." The cutoff values $\varsigma^{th} = 0.50$, the persistence requirement $J = 10$, and the coefficient $\alpha_s = 0.60$ are reduced-form model choices rather than externally estimated quantities: ς^{th} has no direct external anchor, while α_s and J are only partially anchored (Section 5.3). The workfare-over-transfer ranking is therefore conditional on these cutoffs. Section 5 reports a systematic sensitivity sweep that quantifies how far each cutoff must move before the corner policy triggers this channel, and Section 5.3 bounds the channel against the empirical ranges.

2.6. Equilibrium and the steady state

Smooth path. Given parameters and policy $(\tau, p_E, \phi^{\max}, \omega, \dots)$, the system attains a *smooth transition* if, in finite time: (i) $s_t < s^{th} \equiv 0.05$ in finite time (the employment share falls below the absorbing value); (ii) $\min_t C_t \geq C^{min} \equiv q\, w\bar{L}$; (iii) inflation is not persistently negative; (iv) ς_t does not exceed the threshold persistently; (v) the financing constraint is not

violated; (vi) b_t does not diverge. Otherwise the outcome is an *economic collapse* (deflationary spiral / debt / consumption below floor), a *social-instability collapse*, or *not-reached*. In our model the outcome is gated by (ii) the consumption floor and (iv) the social threshold. The deflationary spiral and debt divergence of Theorem 4 are the mechanism through which (ii) is breached once the wage bill collapses and the gap is left unabsorbed, so (ii) nests the spiral rather than competing with it. The labels are ex-post classifications over the full $T = 80$ simulation, not absorbing-state interruptions.

3. Main Results: Analytical Propositions

3.1. Reinstatement collapse drives the labor share monotonically to zero

Theorem 1 (Reinstatement Collapse)**.** *Assume (A1)* $\kappa_I > 0$, $A_t = A_0(1 + g_A)^t$, $A_0 > 0$ *(strictly monotone displacement frontier); (A2) there exists* $\overline{\mathrm{d}N} < \infty$ *with* $\mathrm{d}N_t \le \overline{\mathrm{d}N}$, *and* $\sigma_{t-1} \in [\underline{\sigma}, 1]$. *If for all* $t \ge t_0$,

$$\omega\, \sigma_{t-1}\, \mathrm{d}N_t < \mathrm{d}I_t^{auto,g} = \kappa_I A_t,$$

then n_t *is strictly decreasing, there is a finite* T^* *with* $n_{T^*} = 0$, *and* $s_t = 0$ *for all* $t \ge T^*$.

Proof. (i) While the availability cap is slack, $\mathrm{d}I_t^{auto} = \mathrm{d}I_t^{auto,g}$, and by the premise $\mathrm{d}n_t = \omega\, \mathrm{d}N_t \sigma_{t-1} - \mathrm{d}I_t^{auto} < 0$, so n_t is strictly decreasing while positive. (ii) Uniform negative drift. By A1, $A_t = A_0(1 + g_A)^t$ grows exponentially; by A2, $\mathrm{d}N_t \le \overline{\mathrm{d}N}$ and $\sigma_{t-1} \le 1$. Define

$$t_1 = \max\left\{0,\ \left\lceil \frac{\ln(2\omega\, \overline{\mathrm{d}N}/(\kappa_I A_0))}{\ln(1 + g_A)} \right\rceil \right\}.$$

Then $\kappa_I A_{t_1} \ge 2\omega\, \overline{\mathrm{d}N}$, and for every $t \ge \max\{t_0, t_1\}$ at which the cap is slack,

$$\mathrm{d}n_t = \omega \sigma_{t-1}\, \mathrm{d}N_t - \kappa_I A_t \le \omega\, \overline{\mathrm{d}N} - \kappa_I A_{t_1} \le -\omega\, \overline{\mathrm{d}N} < 0.$$

Hence, while the cap is slack, n_t falls by at least $\omega\, \overline{\mathrm{d}N} > 0$ per period; starting from $n_{t_1} \le N_0$, it reaches the cap region in at most $N_0/(\omega\, \overline{\mathrm{d}N})$ periods. Once the cap binds, $\mathrm{d}I_t^{auto} = n_{t-1} + \eta_t^{cap}\, \mathrm{d}N_t$ and $\mathrm{d}n_t = -n_{t-1}$, so n reaches zero in one further step. The interval up to t_1 is finite, hence $T^* < \infty$ and $n_{T^*} = 0$. (iii) Once $n = 0$, $L_t^D = 0$ and $s_t = 0$; the closed identity $n_t = N_t - I_t$ keeps $n_t = 0$ thereafter. □ □

Corollary 2 (Zero-reinstatement limit, $\omega \to 0$)**.** *Since* $\omega\,\sigma\,\mathrm{d}N_t \le \omega\,\overline{\mathrm{d}N} \to 0 < \kappa_I A_t$*, the premise holds for large* t*. Hence as* $\omega \to 0$ *(AGI takes over new-task creation), the labor share vanishes monotonically with* no self-correcting mechanism*.*

Remark 3. This is consistent with "skills no longer determine wages" (Restrepo, 2025), but here the reinstatement collapse is *endogenous*, driven by κ_N^{AI}/κ_N^h and ω, not an exogenous bounded-complexity terminal state.

3.2. The deflationary spiral

Theorem 4 (Credit-Rationed Income-Flow Collapse)**.** *Assume (B1) there exist* t_0 *and* $\varepsilon > 0$ *such that, for all* $t \ge t_0$*,*

$$C_{t-1} \le \Big(1 + \pi^{lb}/\gamma_p - \varepsilon\Big) C^{fe} \approx 0.867\, C^{fe},$$

so that the inflation floor binds (calibrated $\pi^{lb} = -0.02, \gamma_p = 0.15$*); (B2)* $r_n < -\pi^{lb}$*, so the ZLB gives* $i_t = 0$ *and* $P_t = P_{t-1}(1 + \pi^{lb})$ *falls strictly; (B3) the bank ceiling binds persistently,* $D_t = b^{credit} P_t$*, because the desired net flow exceeds available credit; (B4) after the wage bill collapses the disposable flow is bounded by* $Y_t^d \le \bar{Y}$*, where labor income has fallen to zero and the residual transfers are limited by* tax_{t-1} *and the leakage* μ_{TM}*. Then: (i)* $\pi_t = \pi^{lb} < 0$*,* $i_t = 0$*,* $r_t^d = -\pi^{lb} > 0$*; (ii) the stock does not diverge:* $D_t = b^{credit} P_t$ *falls with* P_t *and* $b_t = b^{credit}$ *stays constant; (iii) under persistent binding the net flow contributed to consumption is*

$$\Delta D_t / P_t = b^{credit}\Big(1 - 1/(1 + \pi^{lb})\Big) \equiv -\delta_{lev} < 0,$$

a real deleveraging forced by the shrinking nominal credit line; (iv) $C_t = Y_t^d - \delta_{lev} \le \bar{Y} - \delta_{lev}$*, and when* $\bar{Y} - \delta_{lev} < C^{min}$ *consumption breaches the floor in finite time, triggering the economic-crash channel.*

Proof. (i) $C_t < C^{fe}$ forces the inflation floor (B1); the ZLB gives $i_t = 0$ (B2) and $r_t^d = -\pi^{lb} > 0$. (ii) The binding ceiling gives $D_t = b^{credit} P_t$; since P_t falls and $i_t = 0$, D_t falls while $b_t = D_t/P_t = b^{credit}$ is constant, so the stock is bounded rather than divergent. (iii) With the ceiling binding in both $t-1$ and t, $D_{t-1} = b^{credit} P_{t-1}$ and $D_t^{roll} = D_{t-1}$; hence $\Delta D_t = D_t - D_{t-1} = b^{credit}(P_t - P_{t-1})$ and $\Delta D_t/P_t = b^{credit}(1 - P_{t-1}/P_t) = b^{credit}(1 - 1/(1+\pi^{lb})) < 0$ because $\pi^{lb} < 0$. (iv) Substituting into the consumption identity gives $C_t = Y_t^d + \Delta D_t/P_t \le \bar{Y} - \delta_{lev}$;

under B4 this lies below C^{min}, so the floor is breached in finite time. The collapse is driven by an insufficient real income flow together with credit rationing, not by an exploding debt stock. □ □

Remark 5. The two conditions cascade: Theorem 1 supplies the source of the gap (wage collapse $wL^D \to 0$), and Theorem 4 characterizes its crash dynamics (ZLB activated, transfers unable to absorb the gap, banks rationing further credit). This upgrades Fornaro–Wolf's "demand shortfall" into an explicit, decidable failure channel in which the crash follows from an insufficient real income flow rather than from an unbounded debt stock.

3.3. Existence of a smooth region and the Laffer interior solution

Proposition 6 (Existence)**.** *If for all t: (C1) $tax_{t-1} \geq E_t^{plan}$; (C2) $C_t \geq C^{min}$; (C3) $\varsigma_t \leq \varsigma^{th}$; (C4) b_t bounded, then $s_t < s^{th} \equiv 0.05$ in finite time with no crash, which defines a smooth transition. The implication is a definitional equivalence rather than an existence proof. Two qualifications make its scope precise. First, C1 is the full-funding condition, and no wide-grid point satisfies it strictly in every period: the count of paths with $tax_{t-1} \geq E_t^{plan}$ at every t is zero. When C1 fails, spending is scaled down by the within-period rule, and a path is still smooth when the scaled spending keeps C2–C4 intact. Second, under that operational criterion the corner $(\tau = 0.15, p_E = 0.45, \phi^{\max} = 0.02)$ and 208 of 384 wide-grid combinations are smooth in direct simulation, so the smooth region is nonempty as a verified computational fact rather than an analytically assumed one.*

Proposition 7 (Laffer interior solution τ^*)**.** *Once the labor share vanishes, $\Pi_t \approx Y_t$. Transition financing capacity*

$$F(\tau) = \tau\,\Pi(Y(\tau)) \approx \tau\,(1 + g_G(1 - \eta\tau))^t(1 + g_{disp}\delta_{disp})$$

is quasi-concave *in τ, with a unique peak*

$$\tau^R \approx \frac{1}{t\,g_G\,\eta},$$

decreasing in transition length t and the inhibition coefficient η. The welfare loss $W(\tau) = \sum_t [gap(\tau) + cost(\tau) + \delta_\tau \tau^2 tax(\tau)]$ is strictly convex in τ (gap decreases concavely, deadweight increases convexly), so there is a unique interior optimum $\tau^* \in (0, \tau^R)$.

Proof. Write $G(\tau) = a - b\tau$ with $a = 1 + g_G$, $b = g_G\eta > 0$, and $\Lambda \equiv 1 + g_{disp}\delta_{disp} > 0$ independent of τ, so $F(\tau) = \Lambda\,\tau\,G(\tau)^t$. Differentiating,

$$F'(\tau) = \Lambda\,G(\tau)^{t-1}\Big[a - b(t+1)\tau\Big].$$

The bracketed term is strictly decreasing and vanishes at $\tau_F = a/[b(t+1)] = (1+g_G)/[g_G\eta(t+1)] \approx 1/(tg_G\eta) = \tau^R$. Since $\Lambda G^{t-1} > 0$, $F' > 0$ below τ_F and $F' < 0$ above it, so τ_F is the unique global maximum; moreover $(\log F)'' = -1/\tau^2 - tb^2/G^2 < 0$, hence F is strictly log-concave and quasi-concave. *Numerical note.* With $g_G = 0.03, \eta = 0.40, t = 80$, $\tau_F \approx 1.06 > 1$; on the economically admissible range $\tau \in [0,1]$ the Laffer ceiling is not binding and F is still increasing, so τ^* is actually pinned by the welfare loss W, not by the financing peak. For welfare, write $W = \sum_t[-B_t + C_t]$ with $B_t' \geq 0$, $B_t'' \leq 0$; we impose the local tax-base freeze used in the convexity argument, treating Π_t as locally constant in τ over a short window, so $C_t = \delta_\tau\tau^3\Pi_t$ and $C_t'' = 6\delta_\tau\tau\Pi_t \geq 2\delta_\tau\,\text{tax}_t > 0$. Then $W'' = \sum_t[-B_t'' + C_t''] > 0$, so W is strictly convex. We have $W'(0) = -B'(0) < 0$. The right-boundary sign $W'(\tau^R) > 0$ is imposed as an explicit decay assumption, $B_t'(\tau) \leq c\,G(\tau)^t$ for some $c > 0$, so that beyond the financing peak the marginal benefit decays while the marginal deadweight $C_t' = 3\delta_\tau\tau^2\Pi_t$ remains non-negligible. Under this decay assumption, the intermediate value theorem gives a unique τ^* with $W'(\tau^*) = 0$, and strict convexity yields $0 < \tau^* < \tau^R$; absent the decay assumption, the interior result is conditional. □

3.4. The p_E^* interior: public employment versus transfers

Proposition 8 (Within-budget superiority of public employment)**.** *Given a tax-budget B split between EP and TM, the marginal contribution to consumption of one fiscal yuan is $\mu_{TM} \in (0,1)$ for transfers (leakage) and 1 for public employment. Since $1 > \mu_{TM}$, public employment is strictly preferred within the budget. Shifting one unemployed worker from TM to EP:*

$$\Delta C = w^P - \mu_{TM}\phi w > 0, \qquad \Delta(\textit{fiscal}) = w^P - \phi w = w(r - \phi), \qquad \Delta_\varsigma = -\alpha_s/\bar{L} < 0.$$

The direct fiscal change is positive only when $\phi < r = w^P/w = 0.85$; on an equal-outcome basis transfers cost $w^P/\mu_{TM} > w^P$ regardless. The optimal p_E^* equates the marginal gap-compression plus social-risk benefit with the marginal fiscal-plus-welfare cost. Under the

explicit end-point assumptions (E0) $MB(0) > MC(0)$ and (E1) $MB(1) < MC(1)$, the loss is U-shaped in p_E and the optimum is interior and finite; otherwise it moves to the corresponding corner.

Proof. One fiscal yuan contributes 1 to consumption under public employment but only $\mu_{TM} < 1$ under transfers, establishing within-budget dominance. With $w^P = rw$, $r = 0.85$, moving one worker from TM to EP gives $\Delta C = w(r - \mu_{TM}\phi) \geq w(0.85 - 0.50) > 0$ and $\Delta\varsigma = -\alpha_s/\bar{L} < 0$; the direct fiscal change is $w(r - \phi)$, positive only when $\phi < r$, and on an equal-outcome basis transfers cost $w^P/\mu_{TM} > w^P$. For the interior, assume MB and MC are continuous on $[0, 1]$; the net marginal $MB - MC$ is strictly decreasing because $MB' \leq 0$ and $MC' \geq 0$. We impose as structural assumptions (E0) $MB(0) > MC(0)$ (at $p_E = 0$ pure relief makes ς maximal and the first workfare unit avoids a high social-risk event) and (E1) $MB(1) < MC(1)$ (at $p_E = 1$ the fiscal bill is maximal and the marginal social benefit of further public employment is zero). Under (E0)–(E1), the intermediate value theorem and strict monotonicity yield a unique $p_E^* \in (0, 1)$ with $MB = MC$, and the loss is U-shaped around it; if either end-point sign fails, the optimum is at the corresponding corner. □

3.5. Social-instability threshold and the workfare channel

Proposition 9. *With $\varsigma_t = \alpha_s(1 - p_E)u_t$ (when $E_t^P = p_E u_t \bar{L} \leq u_t \bar{L}$), let u^{max} be peak unemployment. Define*

$$\alpha^*(p_E) = \frac{\varsigma^{th}}{(1 - p_E)\, u^{max}}.$$

A sufficient condition for a social-instability crash is $\alpha_s > \alpha^*(p_E)$ and *u_t remains near u^{max} for J consecutive periods, so that $\varsigma_t > \varsigma^{th}$ is sustained as in Section 2.5. A single-period peak below J does not trigger the crash even if $\alpha_s > \alpha^*$. α^* is strictly increasing and convex in p_E, and $\lim_{p_E \to 1} \alpha^* = +\infty$ (universal public employment closes the social channel). Hence raising p_E pushes the social boundary outward.*

3.6. The robustness ceiling of the buffer family

Proposition 10 (Structural ceiling $\bar{\kappa}_I$)**.** *An economic crash occurs iff some t has $C_t < C^{min}$, where*

$$C_t = Y_t^d + \Delta D_t/P_t, \qquad Y_t^d = w_t L_t^D + w^P E_t^P + \mu_{TM} TM_t - \mu_d \max\{0, r_t^d\},$$

and the net-borrowing term is bounded: it is at most θ when the ceiling does not bind, and under a binding ceiling with deflation it equals $-\delta_{lev} < 0$ so that credit cannot add to consumption (Theorem 4). Let κ_I determine the timing $t^*(\kappa_I)$ of wage collapse (Theorem 1: larger κ_I earlier) and let $\tau\Pi_t$ accumulate with $(1+g_{eff})^t$. Assume the initial tax base is insufficient to self-finance the floor, $\tau\Pi_0 < C^{min}$. Define the critical shock

$$\bar{\kappa}_I = \inf\Big\{\kappa_I : \min_{t\in[0,T]} C_t(\kappa_I) < C^{min} \text{ for all } (p_E, \phi^{\max}, \tau \le \tau^R)\Big\},$$

where $C_t(\kappa_I)$ is the model consumption under the bounded net-borrowing rule. Then (i) the buffer family protects on $\kappa_I \in (0, \bar{\kappa}_I]$; (ii) for $\kappa_I > \bar{\kappa}_I$ a crash is unavoidable for every *$(p_E, \phi^{\max})$; (iii) $\bar{\kappa}_I$ is governed by the race between tax-base accumulation and wage collapse, $A(t^*(\bar{\kappa}_I)) = \mathrm{Req}(t^*(\bar{\kappa}_I))$ with $\mathrm{Req}(t^*) = \sum_{t=0}^{t^*} E_t^{plan}$. Since buffers are finance-constrained, they can only delay a crash on a finite shock interval; strong shocks require supply-side structural measures (lowering κ_I, a reinstatement engine, steering technical direction).*

Proof. By Theorem 1, $A_t = A_0(1+g_A)^t$ grows exponentially while $\mathrm{d}N_t \le \overline{\mathrm{d}N}$ is bounded; setting $t_1 = \max\{0, \lceil \ln(2\omega\overline{\mathrm{d}N}/(\kappa_I A_0))/\ln(1+g_A)\rceil\}$ gives $\kappa_I A_{t_1} \ge 2\omega\overline{\mathrm{d}N}$ and a uniform negative drift $-\omega\overline{\mathrm{d}N}$ thereafter. Hence $t^*(\kappa_I)$ is finite, nonincreasing in κ_I, and $t^* \to 0$ as $\kappa_I \to \infty$. As $t^* \to 0$ the wage term collapses immediately while cumulative financing $A(t) = \sum_{s\le t}\tau\Pi_s$ approaches $\tau\Pi_0 < C^{min}$; since the net-borrowing contribution is bounded above by θ and cannot exceed the rationed credit line, for sufficiently large κ_I we have $\min_t C_t(\kappa_I) < C^{min}$ under every admissible policy. The defining set S is therefore nonempty and $\bar{\kappa}_I = \inf S$ is well defined, with $\bar{\kappa}_I > 0$ by Proposition 6. *Upward-closure lemma.* If $\kappa_I' \ge \kappa_I$ and $\kappa_I \in S$, then $\kappa_I' \in S$. A larger κ_I accelerates displacement without changing the reinstatement engine, so the wage path deteriorates no later and the bounded, rationed net-borrowing term does not improve it; hence $C_t(\kappa_I') \le C_t(\kappa_I)$ after a finite shift, and a crash for every policy at κ_I implies a crash for every policy at κ_I'. Combining the lemma with the definition of infimum gives (i) protection on $\kappa_I \le \bar{\kappa}_I$ and (ii) an unavoidable crash on $\kappa_I > \bar{\kappa}_I$. The ceiling is the race $A(t^*(\bar{\kappa}_I)) = \mathrm{Req}(t^*(\bar{\kappa}_I))$: faster tax-base accumulation raises $\bar{\kappa}_I$ and stronger tax inhibition lowers it. Buffers therefore succeed only on $(0, \bar{\kappa}_I]$; beyond it supply-side structural measures are required. □

Remark 11 (Summary of the analytical results).

Item	Result	Key structure
P1	Reinstatement collapse $\Rightarrow s_t \to 0$, no self-correction	$\mathrm{d}n = \omega\,\mathrm{d}N\sigma - \mathrm{d}I^{auto}$, displacement dominates (Thm. 1, Cor. 2)
P2	Deflationary spiral emerges	ZLB $r_n < -\pi^{lb}$ + gap unabsorbed (Thm. 4)
P3	Smooth region exists; Laffer interior $\tau^* \in (0, \tau^R)$	$F(\tau)$ quasi-concave, W convex (Props. 6, 7)
P4	p_E^* interior (EP$\succ$TM within budget)	$1 > \mu_{TM}$; fiscal/welfare cost rises (Prop. 8)
P5	Social threshold $\alpha^* \uparrow p_E$; $p_E \to 1$ closes channel	$\varsigma = \alpha_s(1 - p_E)u$ (Prop. 9)
P6	Buffer ceiling $\bar{\kappa}_I$; strong shocks need structure	tax-base vs wage-collapse race (Prop. 10)

4. An Analytic Bifurcation Theory: Boundary Equilibrium Bifurcation of the Reinstatement Mechanism

The switching system of Section 2 is solved numerically and its properties are stated as propositions. To make the collapse mechanism itself analytic, we now derive the fast subsystem directly from the model equations rather than postulating a normal form. Two facts follow from that derivation. First, the induced fast vector field is quadratic, not cubic: its third derivative vanishes identically. Second, the high-employment equilibrium does not meet an interior saddle-node but a *boundary equilibrium bifurcation* (BEB), at which it collides with the piecewise-smooth switching manifold created by the truncation of the human-task share and crosses it with stability preserved under the condition stated below. We then close the model by making the reinstatement rate endogenous to public employment, workfare and retraining, which makes the crossing a policy-conditioned outcome rather than an automatic one: it occurs only when the effective capture reaches the time-varying threshold derived below. As before, the reduction is a local statement; the full switching system remains the object that is calibrated, and the numerical illustration is dimensionless rather than an estimated quantity.

4.1. The fast subsystem: a quadratic vector field

Freeze the slowly evolving state, normalize the state variables

$$k_h \equiv \frac{\kappa_N^h}{N}, \qquad q \equiv \kappa_N^{AI} M_0, \qquad \mu \equiv \frac{A}{N}, \qquad s \equiv \frac{n}{N}, \qquad \sigma \equiv \text{skill}, \tag{19}$$

and write the growth of the task stock and of the labor tasks as

$$\frac{\dot{N}}{N} = k_h S_0 \Big(1 - \lambda_h (1 - s)\Big) + q\mu, \qquad \frac{\dot{n}}{N} = \omega\sigma \, \frac{\dot{N}}{N} - \kappa_I \mu. \tag{20}$$

This reduction uses the direct automation flow before the availability cap binds, $\mathrm{d}I_t^{auto} = \kappa_I A_t$, which is exactly the high-employment region where the human-task share is active and n is large. Since $\dot{s} = \dot{n}/N - s\,\dot{N}/N$, expansion gives the fast vector field in that region,

$$\boxed{\dot{s} = f_1(s) = -Cs^2 + Bs + A} \tag{21}$$

with coefficients

$$\begin{aligned} C &= k_h S_0 \lambda_h > 0, & \Xi &= k_h S_0 (1 - \lambda_h) < 0, \\ B &= C\omega\sigma - \Xi - q\mu, & A &= \omega\sigma(\Xi + q\mu) - \kappa_I \mu. \end{aligned} \tag{22}$$

The decisive structural fact is

$$f_1'''(s) \equiv 0, \tag{23}$$

because the leading nonlinearity in (21) is quadratic. A cubic coefficient on which a cusp normal form would rest cannot be induced from these equations. A one-dimensional quadratic field has a fold-type generic unfolding, but here the event is located not by an interior discriminant but by the boundary of the admissible state space, which is precisely why it is a boundary equilibrium bifurcation rather than an interior fold.

4.2. The switching manifold and the piecewise-smooth system

The human-task share is the truncated function

$$S^h(s) = S_0 \max\Big\{0,\, 1 - \lambda_h (1 - s)\Big\}. \tag{24}$$

It is positive only above the switching manifold

$$s_{\text{floor}} = 1 - \frac{1}{\lambda_h}. \tag{25}$$

For $0 \le s < s_{\text{floor}}$ the human share is identically zero, only the AI-driven component remains, and the fast field in this second region is linear:

$$\dot{s} = f_2(s) = \mu\Big(\omega\sigma q - \kappa_I - q\, s\Big). \tag{26}$$

The two fields join continuously on the manifold, $f_1(s_{\text{floor}}) = f_2(s_{\text{floor}})$, but their slopes differ. Direct subtraction gives the constant jump

$$f_1'(s_{\text{floor}}) - f_2'(s_{\text{floor}}) = k_h S_0\Big(\lambda_h \omega\sigma - \lambda_h + 1\Big). \tag{27}$$

The fast subsystem is therefore a continuous, piecewise-smooth (C^0 but not C^1) system of the standard Filippov type [12].

4.3. Boundary equilibrium bifurcation

Theorem 12 (Boundary equilibrium bifurcation)**.** *For $\mu > 0$ and with σ fixed, a boundary equilibrium bifurcation [52, 51] occurs at*

$$\boxed{\omega_c = \frac{1}{\sigma}\left(\frac{\kappa_I}{q} + s_{floor}\right).} \tag{28}$$

The crossing is transverse, $\partial_\omega f_1(s_{floor}) = \mu q\sigma > 0$. For $\omega < \omega_c$ the region-I root is virtual (it lies outside the physical region) and the field on the manifold points toward the absorbing boundary $s = 0$; for $\omega > \omega_c$ an interior equilibrium $s^+ > s_{floor}$ exists and is stable whenever the persistence condition $q\mu > C\kappa_I/q$ derived below holds.

Proof. By continuity, on the manifold

$$f_1(s_{\text{floor}}) = f_2(s_{\text{floor}}) = \mu\Big(\omega\sigma q - \kappa_I - q\, s_{\text{floor}}\Big). \tag{29}$$

Since $\mu > 0$, the condition $f_1(s_{\text{floor}}) = 0$ is equivalent to $\omega\sigma = \kappa_I/q + s_{\text{floor}}$, which gives (28). Differentiating (29) in ω gives $\mu q\sigma > 0$, establishing transversality. The unique region-II equilibrium of f_2 is

$$s^{**} = \omega\sigma - \frac{\kappa_I}{q}, \tag{30}$$

which equals s_{floor} exactly at $\omega = \omega_c$ and lies below the manifold for $\omega < \omega_c$. The larger root of f_1 likewise equals s_{floor} at ω_c and moves above it for $\omega > \omega_c$. At the boundary equilibrium

the region-II slope is $f_2'(s_{\text{floor}}) = -q\mu < 0$, and using (27) with $\omega\sigma = \kappa_I/q + s_{\text{floor}}$ the region-I slope is

$$f_1'(s_{\text{floor}}) = -q\mu + \frac{C\kappa_I}{q}.$$

It is negative exactly under $q\mu > C\kappa_I/q$. When this persistence condition holds, both one-sided slopes are negative and the equilibrium crosses the manifold with its stability preserved, which is the persistence-type BEB rather than a fold with annihilation. If the condition fails, the region-I branch is repelling and the event is not of persistence type. The calibrated parameters satisfy the condition throughout the reported horizon (Section 4.7). □

The hard lower boundary $s = 0$ contributes a second, structurally simpler event. From (30), the region-II equilibrium enters the physical domain when

$$\omega_0^{(\text{entry})} = \frac{1}{\sigma}\frac{\kappa_I}{q}, \tag{31}$$

at which $s^{**} = 0$. Below this value the physical state space contains no equilibrium at all and the trajectory is absorbed at $s = 0$, which is the collapse. The complete static picture is therefore three regimes: absorption for $\omega < \omega_0^{(\text{entry})}$, a stable low-employment region-II equilibrium between the two thresholds, and a stable high-employment region-I equilibrium above ω_c. Figure 1 depicts this three-regime branch structure and the transverse crossing of the field on the manifold.

4.4. Endogenous reinstatement: policy as the bifurcation parameter

In the baseline model ω is an exogenous constant, and its calibrated value $\omega = 0.05$ lies far below ω_c, so the bifurcation is real but unreachable and the collapse is inevitable under an unchanged policy rule. We now make ω endogenous. Public employment, workfare and retraining reattach workers to the production of new tasks, raising the share of new tasks that accrues to labor. Let EP_t denote public-employment headcount, TM_t workfare and transfer spending, and let the policy stock be

$$\Gamma_t = \gamma_{PE}\frac{EP_{t-1}}{L^S} + \gamma_{TM}\frac{TM_{t-1}}{wL^S} + \gamma_R\,\text{retrain}\cdot\text{skill}_{t-1}, \tag{32}$$

and set the reinstatement rate to

$$\boxed{\omega_t = 1 - (1-\omega_0)e^{-\Gamma_t}.} \tag{33}$$

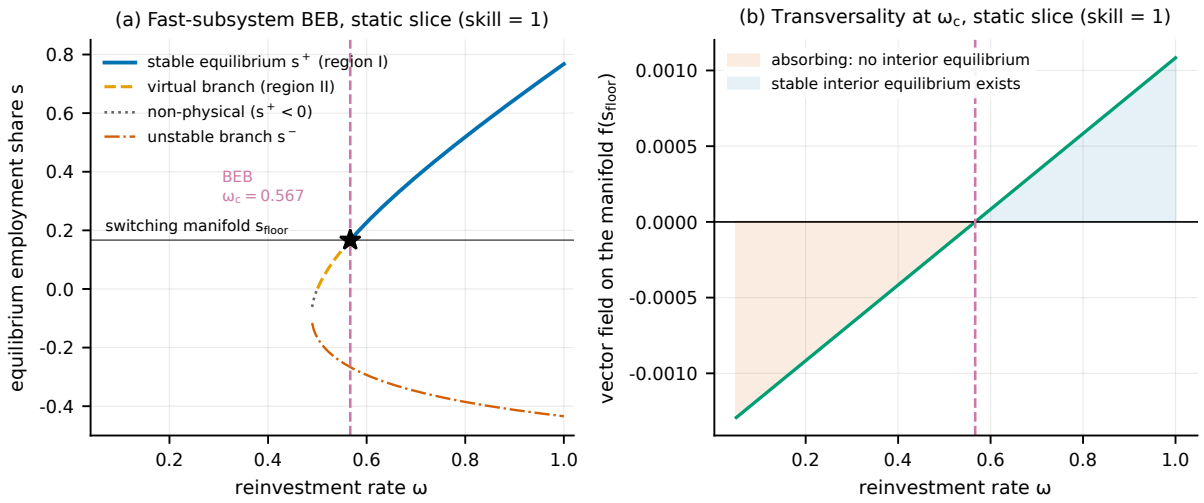


Figure 1: Boundary equilibrium bifurcation of the fast subsystem, static slice with skill fixed at one. Left: the physical equilibrium branch is absorbing at $s = 0$ for $\omega < \kappa_I/q$, rises as a stable region-II (low-employment) equilibrium between κ_I/q and ω_c, and persists through the switching manifold s_{floor} at $\omega_c = 0.567$ into the stable region-I (high-employment) branch; virtual and non-physical roots are shown light. Right: the field on the manifold $f(s_{\text{floor}})$ crosses zero transversely at ω_c. On a dynamic path skill depreciates, so the effective threshold is the time-varying $\omega_c(t)$ reported in Figure 2.

This specification has the required properties. It is bounded, $\omega_t \in [\omega_0, 1]$, monotone and smooth in each policy instrument, and saturating: with no policy it returns to the baseline ω_0, and as the policy stock grows it approaches the pure social-welfare limit $\omega \to 1$, in which new tasks accrue entirely to labor. Using the lagged stock in (32) builds in the implementation delay.

Proposition 13 (Nominal and effective crossing)**.** *The endogenous rate is monotone in the policy stock, $\partial\omega_t/\partial\Gamma_t = (1-\omega_0)e^{-\Gamma_t} > 0$, so it reaches the static value ω_c at the finite stock $\Gamma_c = -\ln\Big((1-\omega_c)/(1-\omega_0)\Big)$. The real bifurcation is governed by the effective capture $\omega_t\, skill_{t-1}$, not by ω_t alone: a nominal crossing $\omega_t \geq \omega_c$ does not imply a real crossing when skill depreciates. The instantaneous threshold on the nominal rate is*

$$\omega_c(t) = \frac{\kappa_I/q + s_{floor}}{skill_{t-1}},$$

which rises as skill falls. A real crossing into the high-employment region requires the effective capture to reach $\kappa_I/q + s_{floor}$, and is therefore conditional on skill being retained.

Proof. The fast-subsystem boundary condition derived in Section 4 is $\omega_t \, \text{skill}_{t-1} = \kappa_I/q + s_{\text{floor}}$; dividing by the lagged skill gives the stated $\omega_c(t)$. Solving (33) for Γ_t at the static value ω_c gives Γ_c and establishes the nominal crossing. Since $\text{skill}_{t-1} \leq 1$ on a depreciation path, $\omega_c(t) \geq \omega_c$, so a nominal crossing cannot by itself satisfy the effective condition. □

4.5. Dynamic verification and the critical policy intensity

The mechanism is verified on the full switching system. Figure 2 contrasts three policy regimes. With no policy, the effective capture never reaches the critical value, the market employment share is absorbed toward zero and consumption breaks through its floor. Under the workfare corner, the nominal rate rises past the static value at $t = 38$, but the effective capture peaks at 0.501 and never reaches 0.567, because the dynamic threshold rises with skill depreciation. The market employment share is consequently absorbed to zero while public employment holds consumption at its floor: the corner defends consumption but does not restore the labor engine. Under the strong social floor, retraining retains skill, the dynamic threshold stays near its static value and the effective capture crosses at $t = 1$; the employment share is retained above one half with consumption well above the floor.

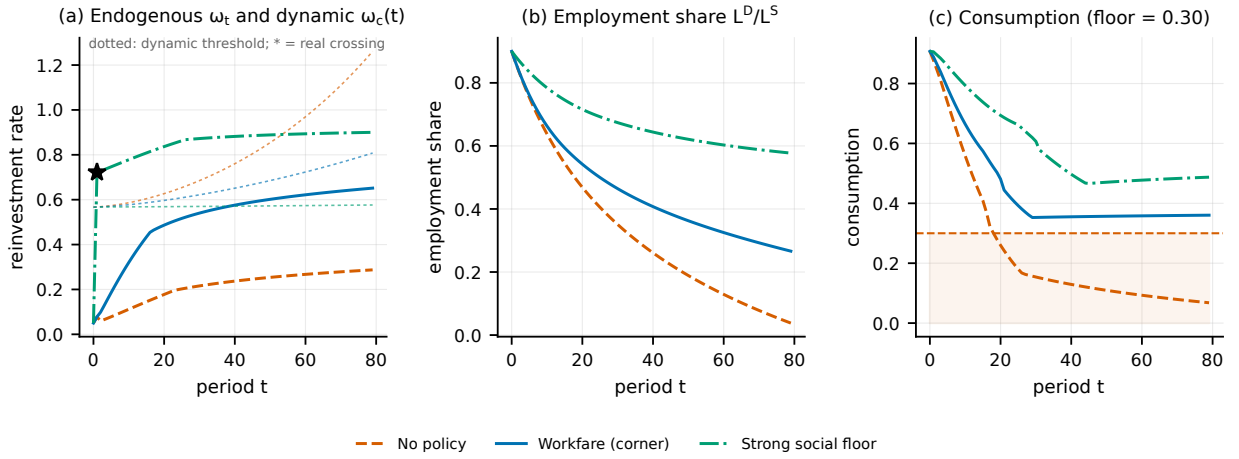


Figure 2: Endogenous reinstatement and the resulting dynamic paths. (a) The endogenous rate ω_t (solid) against its instantaneous dynamic threshold $\omega_c(t)$ (dotted); only the strong floor crosses, at $t = 1$, while the corner's nominal rate crosses the static value without an effective crossing. (b) Employment share and (c) consumption; the strong floor retains employment and consumption, the corner holds consumption at the 0.30 floor as market employment vanishes, and the no-policy path collapses.

A bisection on the public-employment intensity gives the sharp threshold at which consumption is defended, defined as $\min_t C_t \geq C_{\min}$:

$$p_E^* = 0.3552, \tag{34}$$

below which the economy crashes and above which consumption is held at its floor. This is a consumption threshold, not a high-employment threshold: at p_E^* the effective capture does not reach the critical value, so consumption is defended by the fiscal buffer without a restoration of market employment. The long-horizon run ($T = 200$) confirms the distinction: with no policy the employment share reaches zero and $\min C = 0.057$, whereas under the corner with transfers closed ($\phi^{\max} \to 0$) the outcome is smooth with $\min C = 0.350$, and under the strong floor the employment share ends at 0.505 with $\min C = 0.466$ and $\omega = 0.914$.

4.6. Slow–fast dynamics and the finite-rate lag

The endogenous rate is a slow variable and the employment share is a fast variable,

$$\dot{s} = f(s, \omega), \qquad \dot{\omega} = \varepsilon\, g(\omega, \text{policy}), \qquad 0 < \varepsilon \ll 1. \tag{35}$$

Away from the switching manifold the critical manifold $f = 0$ is normally hyperbolic, since the fast slope f_s is nonzero, and the standard persistence theory applies [53]. At the boundary equilibrium the two one-sided slopes in (27) are both nonzero but unequal: the field is C^0 rather than C^1, so the normal hyperbolicity is one-sided rather than lost as at a smooth fold, where $f_s = 0$. We therefore do not invoke the fold-type loss of normal hyperbolicity [54, 50, 55]; the piecewise-smooth persistence theory for Filippov systems is the appropriate framework. The lag seen in the simulations has two sources consistent with this: the slow variable moves at the finite rate ε, so the fast variable tracks a moving equilibrium with a relaxation lag, and crossing the manifold changes the tracking slope discontinuously. On a path without an effective crossing the market employment share therefore keeps declining toward the boundary rather than arresting; only after an effective crossing does it converge to the interior equilibrium, with the relaxation lag visible as a shrinking rate of decline. Reducing ε shrinks the lag, while raising the level of effective capture moves the equilibrium itself; the two are distinct instruments.

4.7. Connection to the calibrated model

The high-employment region-I equilibrium corresponds structurally to the strong social floor that achieves the effective crossing, while the workfare corner corresponds to the fiscally defended state in which consumption is held at its floor as market employment vanishes, and the absorbing regime corresponds to the no-policy and pure-transfer collapses. The coefficients $\gamma_{PE}, \gamma_{TM}, \gamma_R$ and the baseline ω_0 are structural parameters of the reduced subsystem, not externally estimated quantities, and the policy threshold $p_E^* = 0.3552$ is a dimensionless output of the calibrated model under those baseline parameters—illustrative rather than an empirical estimate. A quantitative mapping from the analytic thresholds to the calibrated time path, including a microfoundation of the endogenous reinstatement law (33), is left to future work. On the reported corner path the persistence condition of Theorem 12 holds at every period: the region-I slope $f_1'(s_{\text{floor}})$ stays in $[-0.024, -0.013]$ and is strictly negative, because $q\mu$ exceeds $C\kappa_I/q$ by an order of magnitude. The persistence-type classification is therefore supported by the calibrated parameters rather than asserted for all $\mu > 0$.

Functional form of the saturation. Equation (33) is a modelling choice, so we re-solve the corner with two alternatives that share its endpoints (ω_0 at $\Gamma = 0$ and $\omega \to 1$ as $\Gamma \to \infty$), its monotonicity and its smoothness: a rational form $\omega_t = \omega_0 + (1 - \omega_0)\Gamma_t/(1 + \Gamma_t)$ and a linear-clipped form $\omega_t = \min\{1, \omega_0 + \kappa\Gamma_t\}$, with κ set so that the clipped and exponential forms agree at $\Gamma = 1$. Judged by the effective capture rather than the nominal rate, none of the three forms produces a real crossing at the corner intensity, even when the elasticity γ_{PE} is raised from 3.0 to 4.8. The buffer conclusion is nevertheless robust: $\min_t C_t$ lies in $[0.352, 0.354]$ across all eight solutions. The binding constraint is skill depreciation rather than the shape of the saturation: a monotone reinstatement law acting on a depreciating skill cannot lift the effective capture to the critical value. The functional form is therefore not the margin that decides the outcome, which is consistent with the retraining sweep in which retaining skill is the instrument that produces an early crossing.

5. Calibration

5.1. Parameter–data mapping

Standardization $L^S = \bar{L} = 1$, $w = 1$. In this section ω is held at its exogenous baseline, $\omega = 0.05$, so every threshold reported below is the exogenous-reinstatement calibration. Section 4 endogenizes ω and reports its own threshold, $p_E^* = 0.3552$; the corner minima there differ slightly from those below, and Section 4.7 reconciles the two. Within the exogenous calibration used here, lowering the transfer ceiling to $\phi^{\max} = 0.001$ at the fixed corner coordinates lowers $\min_t C_t$ from the headline 0.357 at $\phi^{\max} = 0.02$ to 0.353, so the 0.003 gap is the buffer carried by a two-percent transfer ceiling. What the model is anchored to, and where the anchoring stops, is the next matter.

What "calibration" means here. Since the term can be read as claiming more than it delivers, we fix its sense before the table. Three entries are anchored to data: the consumption floor q to the U.S. absolute poverty line, the transfer MPC μ_{TM} to the SNAP and CARES low-asset estimates, and the workfare wage ratio w^P/w to workfare programmes. One group sits inside a literature range: the nominal-rigidity slopes γ_p and λ_w correspond to Calvo durations of roughly three quarters. The remaining entries are model-set by explicit convention. Among them κ_I carries a distinct label, *calibration target*: it is set so that the $T = 80$ horizon reaches $s_t \to 0$, which is the collapse the paper studies. Matching a parameter to a terminal condition is legitimate practice, but it means that statements of the form "the transition completes within 80 periods" restate the target rather than test it, and κ_I is not an estimated displacement rate. The social channel $(\alpha_s, \varsigma^{th}, J)$ and the auxiliary balance-sheet and accounting coefficients $(\theta, \chi, b^{credit}, \mu_d, \bar{b}, D_0, \delta_\sigma, g_{disp})$ are conventions as well. "Calibrated" therefore means three data-anchored magnitudes plus a two-parameter literature range, with everything else declared as setting; it does not mean that the parameter vector has been estimated, and no result below depends on reading it that way.

Param	Meaning	Baseline	Anchor / source
$s_0 = (N_0 - I_0)/N_0$	initial labor share	0.90	model initial state $I_0 = 0.20$, $N_0 = 2.00$ gives $s_0 = 0.90$; U.S. labor share 53.8% is a benchmark only *[model initial state; see note]*
κ_I	automation displacement	0.020	transition (T=80) drives $s_t \to 0$ *[calibration target; set to hit $s_t \to 0$ at T=80; not estimated]*
g_A	automation frontier growth	0.010	long-run U.S. TFP $\approx 1\%$/yr; the compute-cost decline is not used [32] *[model-set; see note]*
η	capital-tax growth inhibition	0.40	no direct anchor; a growth-inhibition coefficient, not a tax rate [13, 24] *[model-set; see note]*
γ_p, λ_w	nominal rigidity	0.15, 0.12	Smets–Wouters Calvo $\zeta_p = \zeta_w = 0.75$ (Nakamura–Steinsson; Bils–Klenow) [28, 23, 8] *[literature range]*
μ_{TM}	transfer MPC	0.50	USDA SNAP 0.30; CARES cumulative 0.66; low-asset 0.53; IMF 0.20; Miller 0.44–0.55 [10, 11, 16] *[verified against data]*
q	consumption floor	0.30	U.S. absolute poverty line $\approx$ minimal food $\times 3$ (ASPE/HHS) *[verified against data]*
ω	reinstatement rate	0.05	A&R: reinstatement weaker than displacement [2] *[model-set; direction grounded, magnitude not estimated]*
w^P/w	workfare wage ratio	0.85	MGNREGA / World Bank workfare below market [30] *[verified against data]*

Note. Three entries of the parameter table carry a "see note" flag. The initial share $s_0 = 0.90$ is computed from the task block itself, $s_0 = (N_0 - I_0)/N_0 = (2.00 - 0.20)/2.00$, so it is an internal consistency requirement rather than a data target; the U.S. labor income share of 53.8% (BLS, 2025Q3, incl. self-employment) serves only as a qualitative long-run benchmark, and the gap reflects that s is a task/employment share rather than a wage-bill share and enters no equation. The frontier growth $g_A = 0.01$ is set at the long-run U.S. TFP rate; the -30%/yr hardware-cost decline and $+40\%$/yr efficiency gain reported by Stanford HAI 2025 / NVIDIA [32] refer to the cost of computing, not to A_t, and are deliberately not used as an anchor (sensitivity

in Section 5). The inhibition coefficient $\eta = 0.40$ scales the growth cost of the tax rate in $g_{eff} = g_G(1 - \eta\tau)$ and is not an effective tax rate, so EATR levels (OECD 20.5%, U.S. METR 18.3%) [24] and tax-base elasticities (-0.4 total / -0.7 equipment) [13] serve as magnitudes only. Separately, the symbol σ_t in this paper denotes the skill stock (Section 2.2), not a capital–labor elasticity; the model has no CES production block. The broader elasticity range referenced in task-based calibrations (A&R 2020 P&P ICT $\eta \in (0.5, 0.8)$; K&N > 1; mainstream ≈ 1) is background only and enters no equation [4, 17].

Param	Meaning	Baseline	Anchor / source
α_s	social-pressure coefficient	0.60	$\varsigma_t = \alpha_s U_t^{rem}/\bar{L}$; relief share drives instability *[model-set / calibration convention]*
ς^{th}	social-instability threshold	0.50	sustained $J = 10$-period exceedance $\Rightarrow$ social collapse *[model-set / calibration convention]*
T	simulation horizon	80	transition window over which $s_t \to 0$ is computed *[model-set / calibration convention]*
δ_σ	skill depreciation	0.015	skill stock decay per period unemployed *[model-set / calibration convention]*
g_{disp}	automation output boost	0.05	$\delta_{disp} = (I_t - I_0)/N_0$ output dividend *[model-set / calibration convention]*
θ	borrowing response to gap	0.10	$\theta \max\{0, C^{fe} - Y_t^d\}$ new-borrowing term in the net-flow decision *[model-set / calibration convention]*
χ	amortization of excess debt	0.15	$\chi \max\{0, D_t^{roll} - \bar{b}P_t\}$ net deleveraging rate *[model-set / calibration convention]*
b^{credit}	bank credit ceiling	0.80	hard underwriting bound $D_t \le b^{credit} P_t$ on the debt burden; a stock constraint, not a consumption cut *[model-set / calibration convention]*
μ_d	monetary drag on disposable flow	0.06	$-\mu_d \max\{0, r_t^d\}$ *[model-set / calibration convention]*
$\bar{b}$	debt burden target	0.35	target real debt in the amortization rule *[model-set / calibration convention]*
D_0	initial nominal debt (normalized)	0.30	initial balance sheet *[model-set / calibration convention]*

Baseline policy levers. $\tau = 0.15$ (loss-minimizing corner on the reported grid), $p_E = 0.45$ (workfare-dominant), $\phi^{\max} = 0.02$ (the grid floor; transfers effectively closed under the baseline loss weights).

The transition-loss objective. The grid search ranks policies by a single scalar, and we therefore state that scalar explicitly instead of leaving it implicit in the simulation code. Writing $C^{fe} = w\bar{L}$ for full-employment consumption, the objective for a policy path

$(\tau, p_E, \phi^{\max})$ is

$$\mathcal{L}(\tau, p_E, \phi^{\max}) = \sum_{t=0}^{T} \Big[\max(0, C^{fe} - C_t) + \lambda\, TM_t + \lambda_{PE}\, w^P EP_t + \nu\, EP_t^2 + \delta_\tau\, \tau^2 \mathrm{tax}_t \Big], \quad (36)$$

with $\lambda = 0.5$, $\lambda_{PE} = 0.6$, $\nu = 0.5$ and $\delta_\tau = 0.6$. The four terms are all expressed in consumption units. The first is the consumption gap, the shortfall of realized consumption below what full employment at the prevailing wage would deliver. The second charges transfer outlays TM_t at the leakage rate λ, reflecting that one yuan transferred raises consumption by μ_{TM} rather than by one. The third charges public-employment outlays at the workfare wage, $\lambda_{PE} w^P EP_t$, plus the congestion term νEP_t^2 that makes absorbing a large unemployed pool progressively more expensive. The fourth is the deadweight of the capital tax, quadratic in the rate so that it vanishes as $\tau \to 0$ and produces the Laffer trade-off of Proposition 7. Feasibility is a separate criterion and is not part of $\mathcal{L}$: a path is admissible if $C_t \geq C_{\min} = q\, w \bar{L}$ for every $t \geq 10$, the first ten periods being excluded to remove the initial-condition transient, and the statistic $\min_t C_t$ quoted throughout this section and in Figure 3 refers to that window. Proposition 7 is the one-dimensional projection of (36): with p_E and $\phi^{\max}$ held fixed, the transfer and workfare charges collapse into its single $cost(\tau)$ term and the deadweight enters with the same quadratic form, so $W(\tau)$ and $\mathcal{L}$ rank policies identically along the τ axis. The four weights are conventions rather than estimates: they set the relative price of a consumption shortfall, a fiscal outlay and a tax distortion, and no external data pin them down. What they do and do not control is reported below.

External ranges for the two policy instruments. Both instruments enter the closure mechanically, and two reduced-form ranges in the empirical literature can check those settings without becoming inputs. For workfare the relevant object is the employment multiplier: Lee, Ko and Kim [57] exploit public-sector relocations in South Korea as an exogenous source of public employment and estimate that one public-sector position raises private-sector employment by one, with the effect highly localized. Gechert [56] reports a meta-regression over 104 studies in which public-spending multipliers are close to one and exceed those of tax cuts and transfers by 0.3–0.4. Our closure contains the direct positions and the demand they generate through the consumption block, but not a localized private-employment multiplier; the published one-for-one estimate therefore sits above what we model, and adding it would raise rather

than lower the workfare ranking of Proposition 8. For the pure transfer the relevant object is the labor-supply response. Vivalt et al. [58] report, from the OpenResearch experiment that paid $1,000 per month for three years to 1,000 low-income adults against 2,000 controls, a 2.0 percentage-point fall in labor-market participation and a 1.3–1.4 hour reduction in weekly hours. Our model has no hours margin, so a transfer leaves labor supply unchanged; that omission flatters the pure transfer, since a smaller effective labor supply would shrink the tax base that has to carry the buffer. Both gaps therefore run in the direction that makes the ranking harder, not easier, to establish: the missing multiplier weakens workfare and the missing labor-supply response strengthens the pure transfer. Filling either with the published range moves the comparison the same way. Neither range enters an equation, and this is the sense in which the policy claims are model-implied rather than universal.

5.2. Robustness of the analytical results under the calibrated parameters

Figure 3 reports the baseline path under the corner configuration. Under the calibrated parameters ($\mu_{TM} = 0.50$, $\eta = 0.40$), transfers are costly relative to public-employment wages (one yuan of transfers yields 0.50 of consumption, whereas a public-employment wage yields 1), and the capital tax carries a Laffer supply-side cost. Running the full battery under the unified model engine yields the following calibrated outcomes:

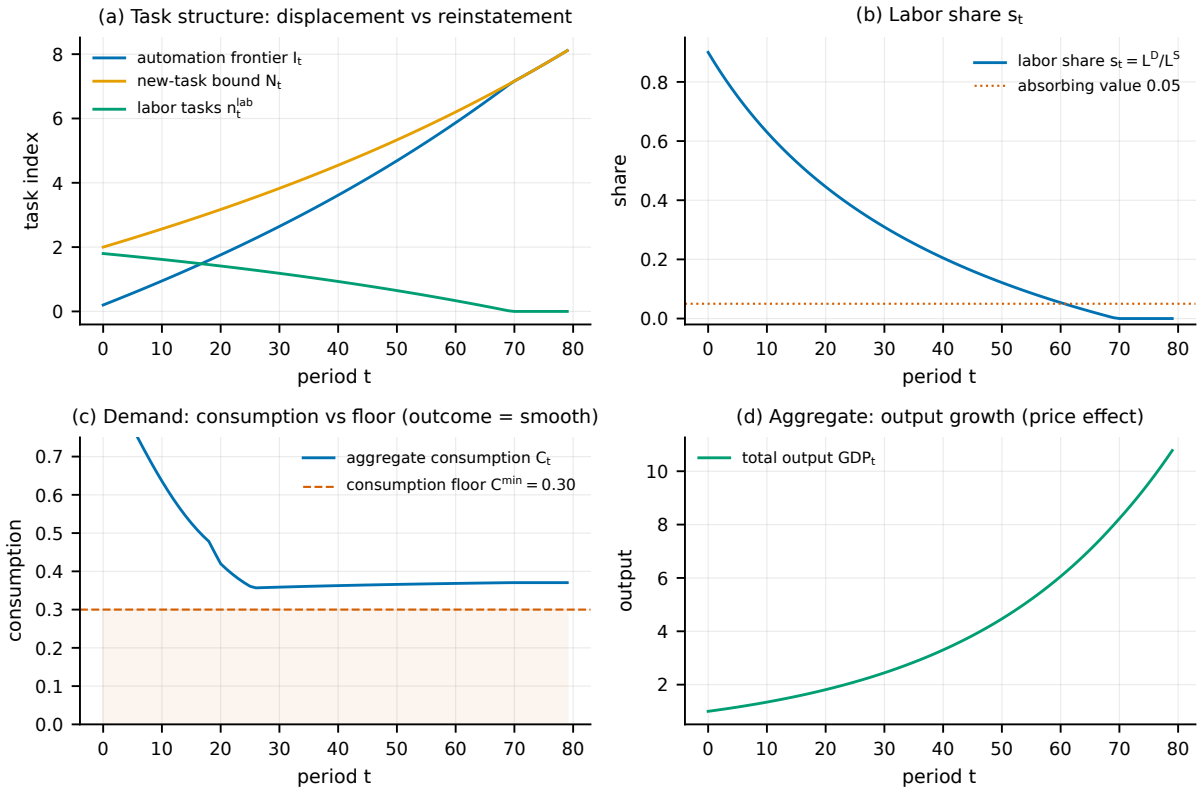


Figure 3: Baseline smooth transition under the corner configuration ($\tau = 0.15, p_E = 0.45, \phi^{\max} = 0.02$) at the baseline frontier growth $g_A = 0.010$. (a) The automation frontier I_t and new-task bound N_t diverge while labor tasks n_t^{lab} vanish. (b) The labor share declines monotonically to its absorbing value. (c) Aggregate consumption stays above the floor $C^{min} = 0.30$ (minimum 0.357). (d) Total output keeps rising through the transition.

Result	Calibrated outcome	Conclusion
Policy delay d	corner ($\phi^{\max}$=0.02): d=0 and d=12 both smooth (0.357); standard ($\phi^{\max}$=0.65): d=0 and d=12 both smooth (0.358 and 0.366)	delay immaterial at the corner and under the standard setting
Isolation gain Δ vs ω	$0.02 \to 0.49$	monotone, robust
Workfare vs pure transfer	6/6 not crashed vs 6/6 crashed	workfare > transfer at every ω
Minimum-loss point (grid)	$(0.10, 0.40, 0.02)$	corner: workfare-dominant, close transfers, low tax
Feasible share, p_E=0.45 vs 0.30	64.1% vs 26.6%	advantage retained
No-policy / pure-transfer	crash / all crash	buffering and financing necessary

The feasible share is the fraction of the 8×8 $(\tau, \phi^{\max})$ cells at the stated p_E that are smooth under the operational criterion in Proposition 6, evaluated on the same wide grid: $41/64 = 64.1\%$ at $p_E = 0.45$, $17/64 = 26.6\%$ at $p_E = 0.30$, and $208/384 = 54.2\%$ over the grid as a whole. The workfare–transfer row is a same-fiscal comparison: the two regimes use the identical ($\tau = 0.16, \phi^{\max} = 0.65$) and differ only in p_E (0.45 public employment versus 0 pure transfer). Across six ω values, workfare survives all six ($\omega = 0.02$ and 0.05 hold the floor at 0.351 and 0.358), the pure transfer crashes in all six, and workfare carries the lower total loss in all six.

The public-employment intensity is load-bearing. The same six ω values at the corner $(0.15, 0.02)$ survive at $p_E = 0.45$ ($\min_t C_t = 0.352$–0.357) but all collapse at $p_E = 0.30$ ($\min_t C_t = 0.244$–0.265, every path through the floor). The corner survives only above a public-employment share of about 0.36, a feasibility bound rather than a tuning preference.

Key calibrated narrative. (i) The six analytical results P1–P6 are reproduced under the calibrated parameters within the reported grid; four are visible in this section: the reinstatement collapse drives $s_t \to 0$; skill-retention value decays monotonically in ω (Figure 6); workfare ranks above the pure transfer in the modeled crash channels; and the protective combination widens the surviving region. (ii) Under the baseline loss weights the minimum-

loss point on the grid moves to a corner solution (workfare-dominant, transfers closed, minimal sufficient capital tax) driven by the MPC calibration. (iii) Within this calibrated model, no-policy and pure-transfer regimes are infeasible under the unified engine (financing-constraint collapse), reinforcing the paper's model-implied message: *a smooth transition requires a policy buffer and that the buffer be financed*. Figure 4 contrasts the three regimes on the consumption margin.

Sensitivity to g_A and η. Two calibration entries admit no verifiable external anchor, the automation-frontier growth g_A and the capital-tax growth inhibition η, so we sweep both and report the outcome instead of asserting that the baseline values are innocuous. Varying g_A over $\{0.010, 0.05, 0.10, 0.20, 0.30\}$ at the corner gives minimum consumption $0.357, 0.344, 0.294, 0.237, 0.222$ and outcome smooth, smooth, crash, crash, crash. The financed buffer therefore holds at $g_A = 0.05$, one sixth of the -30%/yr hardware-cost decline often quoted for computing; the floor is breached only at $g_A = 0.10$, and at $g_A \geq 0.20$ the transition crashes hard with a rapidly accumulating loss. This remains the sharpest sensitivity in the calibration, and the smooth conclusion should be read as conditional on a conservative long-run-TFP frontier growth rate rather than on a hardware-cost rate. By contrast η is nearly inert over the admissible tax range: sweeping η from 0.20 to 0.80 leaves every corner outcome smooth at $\min_t C_t = 0.357$ and moves the total loss by about 0.1%, so the imprecision of η affects no conclusion, while also implying that no sharp Laffer effect can be claimed at $\tau = 0.15$. Both sweeps are reproducible from the replication script with the corner configuration.

Grid minima and identification. Figure 5 visualizes the loss surface. Three minima are reported. A scan that fixed $\phi^{\max} = 0.15$ returns $(0.18, 0.40, 0.15)$ with loss 63.53; the wide grid, which extends $\phi^{\max}$ down to 0.02, returns the corner $(0.15, 0.45, 0.02)$ with loss 63.14; and a denser grid that extends $\phi^{\max}$ to 0.001 returns $(0.10, 0.40, 0.001)$ with loss 62.81, taken up below. The three are ordered monotonically in the ceiling—the lower the cap on transfers, the lower the minimized loss—with a total spread of about 1.1%. The loss surface is locally flat, so the exact coordinates are grid-dependent rather than sharply identified. We report the wide-grid corner as the headline because it retains a visible buffer.

A refinement test addresses the boundary directly. Re-solving on a denser grid—capital-

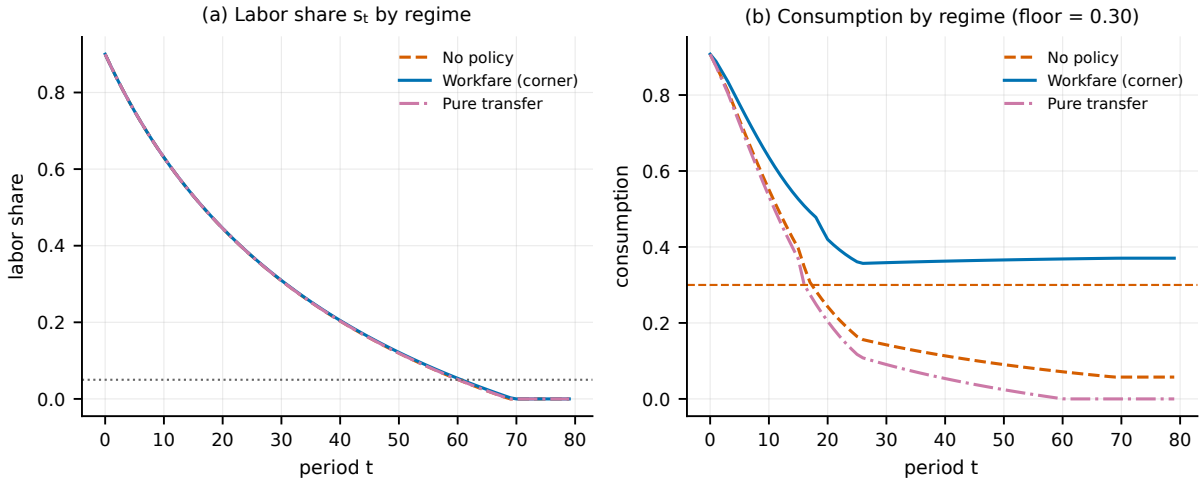


Figure 4: Policy-regime comparison. Each regime carries its own fiscal setting: no policy ($\tau = 0.05, \phi^{\max} = 0.15$), the workfare corner ($\tau = 0.15, p_E = 0.45, \phi^{\max} = 0.02$), and the pure transfer ($\tau = 0, \phi^{\max} = 0.65$). This is therefore a comparison of regimes rather than a same-fiscal instrument test, which is given in the table above. (a) The labor share s_t follows the same task-driven decline under all three regimes. (b) The workfare corner holds aggregate consumption above the floor, whereas the no-policy and pure-transfer regimes fall below it and become infeasible; the consumption buffer, not the market employment count, is what distinguishes the regimes.

tax step 0.01, workfare step 0.02, and $\phi^{\max}$ extended down to 0.001—moves the minimizer to $(0.10, 0.40, 0.001)$ with loss 62.81, against 63.14 on the wide grid, a relative difference of 0.52%. The transfer ceiling is monotone in the same direction: holding $(\tau, p_E) = (0.15, 0.45)$, lowering $\phi^{\max}$ from 0.10 to 0.001 lowers the loss from 63.19 to 63.13 and $\min_t C_t$ from 0.371 to 0.353. Closing transfers is therefore a preference of the objective rather than a grid-resolution artifact, but two caveats remain. The exact corner coordinates are not identified, and the denser solution carries a thin buffer: $\min_t C_t = 0.3071$ against a floor of 0.300, so it clears by about seven thousandths. The refined solution is reported here to show what the objective does once the grid stops being the binding constraint.

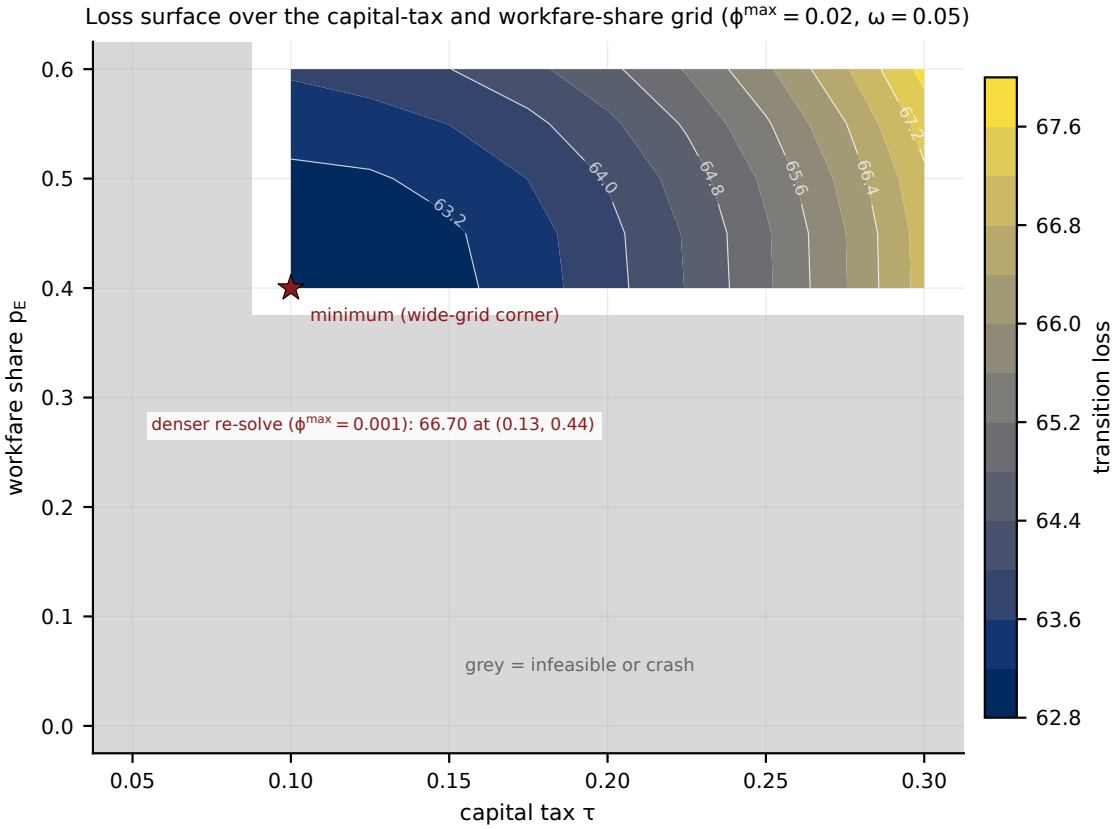


Figure 5: Transition loss over the capital-tax and workfare-share grid at $\phi^{\max} = 0.02$, $\omega = 0.05$. The grey region is infeasible (crash); the smooth region is confined to high workfare shares, and under the baseline loss weights the loss-minimizing point on this grid sits at its corner (solid star). The smooth surface is locally flat, so the minimizer's exact coordinates are grid-dependent rather than identified. A denser re-solve that extends $\phi^{\max}$ to 0.001 moves the minimizer to $(0.10, 0.40)$ with a loss of 62.81 (stated in the panel); that location is not a point on the $\phi^{\max} = 0.02$ surface drawn here, which is why it is reported in words rather than marked.

Sensitivity to the loss weights. The weights in (36) are conventions, so we report what they do and do not control rather than asserting that they are innocuous. Feasibility is weight-independent by construction: re-ranking all 384 grid points under six weight configurations leaves the admissible set at 208 points in every case, so whether a path is smooth or crashes does not depend on λ, λ_{PE}, ν or δ_τ, and the feasible shares reported above are unaffected. The ranking among admissible paths does depend on them. The configuration $(0.10, 0.40, 0.02)$ is selected in three of the six configurations (the baseline, flat and tax-heavy weights). The remaining configurations move the minimizer: halving the cost weights relative to the gap gives $(0.20, 0.55, 0.65)$ with $\min_t C_t = 0.431$, and doubling them gives $(0.12, 0.30, 0.20)$ with $\min_t C_t = 0.303$. In every configuration public employment remains the dominant instrument, with $p_E \in [0.30, 0.55]$, whereas the transfer ceiling ranges from 0.02 to 0.65. Workfare dominance is thus a property of the model, while the statement that transfers are closed at the optimum is a property of the baseline weights together with the lower grid bound, and is reported as such.

Stochastic robustness. The analytical results are deterministic, and a deterministic path should not be presented as if it stood in for a stochastic one. We therefore shock the frontier growth itself, the parameter on which the smooth conclusion most depends. The growth rate becomes $g_{A,t} = 0.010 + \varepsilon_t$ with an AR(1) deviation ($\rho = 0.5$, Gaussian innovations of standard deviation σ (the shock scale, distinct from the skill index σ_t)), the engine is otherwise unchanged, and each configuration is run 200 times; a path is recorded as a crash when it triggers the economic or social crash test before the horizon ends. Table 1 reports the results.

Table 1: Monte Carlo crash counts under frontier-growth shocks (200 replications; AR(1), $\rho = 0.5$). Buffer is $\min_t C_t - 0.300$; the last column reports the fifth percentile of $\min_t C_t$ at $\sigma = 0.03$.

Configuration	buffer	σ=0.01	σ=0.02	σ=0.03	$\min_t C_t$, 5%
Headline $(0.15, 0.45, 0.02)$	0.057	0/200	0/200	0/200	0.3546
Denser $(0.10, 0.40, 0.001)$	0.007	0/200	0/200	0/200	0.3330

Two things follow. First, neither configuration produces an economic crash across the shock sizes considered, because the balance-sheet-consistent household block keeps the debt

stock bounded and the financed buffer defends consumption. At $\sigma = 0.03$, however, 26 of the 200 paths fail to drive the labor share to its absorbing value within T because the shock raises the frontier, which we count as neither survival nor crash. Second, the margin still separates the two configurations even though neither crashes. The headline corner, with a buffer of 0.057, holds its fifth-percentile minimum consumption at 0.355; the denser minimum-loss configuration, which clears the floor by only 0.007, sees its fifth-percentile minimum consumption fall to 0.333. Minimizing the loss therefore pushes the design toward the floor and leaves a thinner cushion against shocks, even though the bounded debt block prevents a hard crash at the scales tested. This is the quantitative counterpart of the qualitative statement above: the buffer buys time, and its thickness determines how much. Demand-side, monetary and policy-implementation shocks are not modelled, and a fully stochastic version of the model remains for future work (Section 7).

Two configurations, not one. The smooth headline depends on the public-employment intensity rather than on the transfer ceiling. At the baseline $\omega = 0.05$, the wide-grid corner $(0.15, 0.45, \phi^{\max} = 0.02)$ runs smooth with $\min C = 0.357 > C^{min} = 0.30$. Under the standard setting $(\tau = 0.16, p_E = 0.45, \phi^{\max} = 0.65)$ used in the social-channel comparison of Table 2, the point $(0.16, 0.30, 0.65)$ runs smooth at $\min C = 0.333$, while $(0.16, 0.45, 0.65)$ runs smooth at $\min C = 0.358$. The binding condition is therefore the workfare share p_E, not a tight transfer ceiling: under the standard setting both workfare shares clear the floor, and a higher share raises the consumption margin. The sharp threshold separating smooth from crash for this standard calibration is $p_E = 0.167$, below the 0.30 point.

Social-threshold sensitivity sweep. A dedicated social-channel sweep uses the model engine and varies one social-channel parameter at a time: ς^{th} over 0.20–0.70, α_s over 0.30–1.20, and J over 3–30, plus a two-dimensional $\varsigma^{th} \times \alpha_s$ grid, under the calibrated parameters $(\eta = 0.40, \mu_{TM} = 0.50)$. Three policies are compared: the recommended corner $(\tau = 0.15, p_E = 0.45, \phi^{\max} = 0.02)$, the standard setting $(\tau = 0.16, p_E = 0.45, \phi^{\max} = 0.65)$, and the pure transfer $(p_E = 0)$ as the extreme social-channel case. Table 2 reports baseline outcomes; Table 3 reports the stability/crash boundaries.

The two-dimensional grid for the corner (S = social crash, . = no social crash) traces the same boundary:



Figure 6: Isolation experiment: the loss saved by retraining Δ rises monotonically with the reinstatement rate ω, the share of new tasks accruing to labor. As $\omega \to 0$ (AGI takes over new-task creation and reinstatement fails), the value of retraining vanishes, confirming that skill retention pays off only while labor can still capture new tasks.

Table 2: Baseline social-channel outcomes ($\varsigma^{th} = 0.50, \alpha_s = 0.60, J = 10$, $g_A = 0.010$). Values within 10^{-3} of the floor are given to four decimals.

Policy	outcome	crash type	min C	peak stress	social crash
Corner $(0.15, 0.45, 0.02)$	smooth	none	0.357	0.330	no
Standard $(0.16, 0.45, 0.65)$	smooth	none	0.3577	0.330	no
Pure transfer $(0.16, 0, 0.65)$	crash	both	0.2589	0.600	yes

$\varsigma^{th} \backslash \alpha_s$	0.45	0.60	0.75	0.90	1.20
0.25	.	S	S	S	S
0.30	.	S	S	S	S
0.33	.	.	S	S	S
0.40	.	.	S	S	S
0.50	.	.	.	.	S

Mechanism. At $p_E = 0.45$, public employment absorbs 45% of the unemployed and only 55% remain on pure relief, so $\varsigma_t = \alpha_s(1 - p_E)u_t = 0.55\,\alpha_s u_t$, peaking at $0.55\,\alpha_s\,u^{max} = 0.330$

Table 3: Social-crash boundaries under one-at-a-time sweeps.

Swept parameter (baseline)	Corner	Standard	Pure transfer
critical ς^{th} (base 0.50)	0.33	0.33	0.60
critical α_s (base 0.60)	0.91	0.91	0.50
critical J (base 10)	never triggers	never triggers	all $J \in [3, 30]$

Values below/above the boundary trigger the social crash; for ς^{th} a lower value triggers, for α_s a higher value triggers.

at the baseline $\alpha_s = 0.60$ with $u^{max} = 1$, which is 34% below the 0.50 cutoff. The analytic boundaries are therefore exact: $\varsigma^{th}_{crit} = 0.33$ and $\alpha^{crit}_s = 0.50/0.55 = 0.909$. In the run that tightens the cutoff toward the boundary, the first sustained exceedance occurs late in the transition (periods 24–55 under the ςth scan), consistent with stress building only as unemployment approaches its peak. Under the pure transfer, 100% of the unemployed stay on relief and ς_t peaks at $\alpha_s = 0.60 > 0.50$, triggering the social channel at the baseline.

Conditional conclusion. The workfare-over-transfer ranking does *not* flip within the scanned range; the sweep strengthens it. To make the recommended corner socially crash, ς^{th} would have to fall from 0.50 to below 0.33 (a 34% reduction) or α_s rise from 0.60 to above 0.91 (a 52% increase), while the pure transfer already socially crashes at the baseline. The persistence count J is immaterial to the corner because stress never exceeds the cutoff at baseline. The ranking remains conditional on the reduced-form cutoffs, whose external empirical anchoring we examine separately (Section 5.3); it is backed by quantified robustness margins rather than a qualitative caveat.

5.3. External empirical anchoring of the social-instability parameters

The social-instability channel contains three reduced-form parameters: the social-crash cutoff ς^{th} (baseline 0.50), the stress coefficient α_s (baseline 0.60), and the sustained-exceedance window J (baseline 10 periods, one model period being one year). We search the empirical literature for mappable evidence for each parameter, distinguish direct anchors from indirect (directional) evidence, and state the mapping assumptions explicitly. Table 4 summarizes the anchoring status.

Table 4: External empirical anchoring status of the three social-instability parameters.

Parameter	Baseline	Anchoring status	Nature of evidence
ς^{th}	0.50	no direct external anchor	directional/continuous probability only; no normalized cutoff
α_s	0.60	partially anchored	reverse-engineered range 0.5–2.5; 0.60 at the lower end
J	10	partially anchored	mean/upper-tail scale (crisis 8–10 yrs; civil-war mean 11.1 yrs)

The cutoff $\varsigma^{th} = 0.50$: no direct external anchor. No study provides a population-dependency threshold that maps onto a 0.50 cutoff of the $[0, 1]$ normalized stress variable. The authoritative literature consistently reports continuous probability or dose–response relationships rather than structural thresholds replicable across samples. Using rainfall as an instrument across 41 African countries over 1981–1999, Miguel, Satyanath and Sergenti [33] identify that a five-percentage-point drop in real GDP growth raises the probability of conflict in the following year (at least 25 battle deaths) by about 12 percentage points, a relative increase of roughly 50%. Ponticelli and Voth [34], across 25 European countries over 1919–2008, find that a one-standard-deviation spending cut (about 2.8 percentage points of GDP) adds roughly 0.4 unrest events per year, with the event count nearly doubling as cuts widen from 1% to 10% of GDP; only a descriptive soft cutoff around a 2%-of-GDP cut appears, not an identified structural threshold. Using natural disasters as instruments, Bellemare [35] identifies that a one-unit rise in the global food price index adds about 0.99 food-related unrest reports per month, while price volatility has no significant effect. Earlier work by Collier and Hoeffler [45], Fearon and Laitin [46], and Alesina and Perotti [47] likewise reports continuous marginal effects. The only explicit numerical cutoff, due to Lagi, Bertrand and Bar-Yam (2011, arXiv:1108.2455, not peer reviewed), clusters protests when the FAO food price index exceeds 210; but that cutoff is a price-index level rather than a population dependency ratio, and mapping it onto $\varsigma^{th} = 0.50$ would require an over-long chain of normalization assumptions, so we do not adopt it as a direct anchor.

The stress coefficient $\alpha_s = 0.60$: partially anchored, with an identifiable range. The sign with which unemployment or relief dependence raises property crime and social unrest is robust across U.S., European and cross-country panels, ruling out $\alpha_s \leq 0$. The literature reports crime semi-elasticities to unemployment of roughly +1.3% to +4% per percentage point of unemployment, concentrated in property crime with weak effects on violent crime. Raphael and Winter-Ebmer [36] find that a one-percentage-point fall in unemployment lowers property crime by about 1.6%–2.4%; Lin [37] identifies a 1.8% OLS and 4.0% 2SLS rise in property crime per extra percentage point of unemployment; Gould, Weinberg and Mustard [38] find that the 23.3% decline in low-skill male wages over 1979–1993 accounts for 43% of the rise in property crime; Buonanno, Drago and Galbiati [39], across about 20 developed countries over 1970–2010, identify a roughly 1.3% rise in total crime and 1.7% rise in homicides per extra percentage point of unemployment; and Fougère, Kramarz and Pouget [40] identify a significant positive effect of youth unemployment on property crime in France; see also the surveys by Freeman [48] and Draca and Machin [49]. Mapping these semi-elasticities $\beta_{crime} \approx \partial \log C / \partial u$ onto $\alpha_s = \partial \,\text{stress} / \partial r$ requires three layers of assumptions: (A) the normalized range linking the stress index to disorder indicators, setting stress = 1 to correspond to a 3–10-fold amplification of crime over baseline (mapping slopes of about 0.43–0.91); (B) the conversion factor $k = r/u$ between the relief share r and unemployment u (about 0.4); and (C) a local linearization treating the semi-elasticity as approximately constant over the working range. Under transparent versions of these assumptions, $\alpha_s \approx f' \beta_{crime}(1/k)$ reverse-engineers a defensible range of about 0.5–2.5. The baseline 0.60 sits at the lower end of this range: neither rejected nor specifically supported by the literature, it is a reasonable but conservative calibration rather than an empirically identified value.

The sustained-exceedance window $J = 10$: partially anchored at mean/upper-tail scale. No study directly estimates the window of consecutive stress exceedance that triggers a crash. Annual-scale evidence brackets ten years along two independent lines. First, after systemic banking crises, per-capita GDP returns to its pre-crisis peak in about eight years on average (median 6.5 years), with 45% of episodes experiencing a second dip [41]; Cerra and Saxena [42] find highly persistent, near-permanent output losses after banking crises, with later estimates placing the average post-crisis GDP loss at about ten years. Second, civil wars last 11.1

years on average (median 7.1 years) [43], and the hazard estimates of Collier, Hoeffler and Söderbom [44] average just over seven years, with wars begun in the 1980s lasting 105 months (about 8.75 years). On the other side, protest waves and crime shocks persist only months to 2–5 years, markedly shorter than ten years. $J = 10$ is therefore a defensible mean/upper-tail anchor aligned with chronic post-crisis slumps and average civil wars, but it lies above the median durations and should be read as such rather than as a median anchor.

Parameter decision and empirical-range robustness. Because none of the three parameters has a precise, directly identified empirical replacement, and the baseline values all lie within defensible empirical ranges, we do not adjust the baseline: assigning a value to ς^{th} would lack mappable threshold evidence; $\alpha_s = 0.60$ lies inside the reverse-engineered range 0.5–2.5; and $J = 10$ is a supported mean/upper-tail value. A dedicated empirical-range sweep extends the α_s scan across the full 0.5–2.5 range alongside a directional ς^{th} scan. The analytic boundaries are $\alpha_s^{crit} = 0.50/((1 - 0.45)u^{max}) = 0.909$ (with $u^{max} = 1$) and $\varsigma_{crit}^{th} = 0.33$, and the numerical sweep locates the first social crash at $\alpha_s = 0.91$ (smooth at 0.90) and between $\varsigma^{th} = 0.30$ and 0.33 (smooth at 0.33); $\min C$ stays 0.357 throughout because the social channel does not feed back into the economic paths. The first sustained exceedance occurs late in the transition (periods 24–70 in the α_s sweep). The baseline conclusion does not flip: the corner stays smooth at the baseline and across the lower empirical range, turning to a social crash only when α_s rises above 0.91 or ς^{th} falls below 0.33; the sweep thereby bounds the channel's fragility to high-end parameter values.

6. Contribution to the Literature

The existing AGI macroeconomics literature addresses the transition along three separate axes. Restrepo (2025) and Korinek–Suh (2024) characterize the *supply-side* conditions under which automation collapses wages; Fornaro–Wolf (2026) trace the *demand-side* channel from income shifts to the natural rate; and the fiscal-instrument literature treats taxes and transfers as optimal-schedule objects. What none of them does is join the axes, so that the size and the financing of the buffer and the existence of the high-employment branch are decided together rather than separately. This paper proposes a two-layer task model that:

1. **Endogenizes the reinstatement collapse** (driven by AGI participation κ_N^{AI} and the reinstatement rate ω), proving the labor share vanishes monotonically (Theorem 1), and shows skill-retention value decays with ω, with no value as $\omega \to 0$.
2. **Upgrades Fornaro–Wolf's demand shortfall into a decidable deflationary spiral** (Theorem 4), cascading the collapse source (Theorem 1) into crash dynamics.
3. **Characterizes the fiscal closure**: a Laffer interior tax τ^* (Proposition 7) and within-budget superiority of public employment over transfers (Proposition 8).
4. **Introduces a social-instability channel independent of economic deflation**, proving workfare dominates the pure transfer for social-instability risk (Proposition 9), complementing the qualitative Tcherneva/Ravallion debate and the basic-income-versus-job-guarantee comparison of Mitchell and Watts [31, 25, 21].
5. **Establishes a robustness ceiling for the buffer family** (Proposition 10): strong shocks require supply-side structural measures, a result absent from the literature.
6. **Closes the open question on the reinstatement rate with an analytic bifurcation theory**. Acemoglu–Restrepo treat κ_N (in their notation) as an exogenous constant and leave its determinants open; we derive the fast subsystem directly from the model and show that the high-employment branch reaches and crosses the switching manifold through a persistence-type boundary equilibrium bifurcation, continuing as a stable low-employment branch on the other side. This yields a closed-form critical reinstatement rate, an endogenous policy rule that can carry the effective capture across the time-varying threshold when skill is retained, and a finite-rate lag between the slow policy and fast employment variables (Section 4). The reduction is a local statement whose parameters are dimensionless and illustrative rather than estimated, so the claim is structural rather than quantitative.

Calibration anchors three magnitudes to data (the consumption floor, the transfer MPC and the workfare wage ratio); the initial labor share $s_0 = 0.90$ follows from the model's own task block, the U.S. labor share of 53.8% is a qualitative benchmark rather than a target, and the elasticity range and the -30%/yr compute-cost decline are background and enter no equation (Section 5). The grid search returns a "workfare-dominant + capital-tax-financed"

corner whose coordinates are grid-dependent rather than uniquely identified, providing an analyzable and quantitative basis for a smooth AGI transition.

Related empirical work grounds the task and labor-share foundations. The skill-content framework originates with Autor, Levy and Murnane [7]; exposure to robots is estimated to reduce local employment and wages [3]; and the declining labor share is linked to the reallocation of value toward superstar firms [6]. Broader policy-oriented analyses emphasize the distributional harms of AI deployed along its current trajectory [1] and the need for development strategies that share the gains from artificial intelligence more widely [19].

Several recent papers address adjacent mechanisms, and in each case the difference lies along a specific axis. Atolia, Holland and Kreamer [5] solve for the majority-voting optimal capital tax and basic income after an episode of automation, characterizing long-run outcomes and transitional welfare. Their policy is an optimal tax–transfer schedule; ours treats the two instruments as parameters of a bifurcation unfolding and asks when the high-employment branch crosses the switching manifold. Kleven and Zidar [18] characterize optimal labor and capital income taxation in a task-based automation model calibrated to the U.S. wage distribution, and find a sizable optimal capital tax that is, in their benchmark, unaffected by automation. Our capital tax is not an optimal-tax object: it is the financing instrument of the buffer, and what matters for us is the tax base, which shrinks as $s_t \to 0$, so the constraint we identify is fiscal feasibility rather than tax optimality. Ray and Mookherjee [26] derive the long-run labor share in a growth framework where automation moves the share along a smooth path; we study the case in which the reinstatement engine itself collapses, so the share crosses the switching manifold through a boundary bifurcation rather than following a continuous decline. Nakamura and Zeira [22] analyze transitional unemployment dynamics and identify conditions under which assistance arrives in time; their object is the unemployment stock, ours is the existence of an equilibrium branch. Bond and Kremens [9] characterize income and inequality under asymptotically full automation, a steady-state distribution question, whereas our constraint is fiscal feasibility along the transition. Jacobs [15] studies capitalist–worker wealth distribution in a task-based model without a policy-instrument bifurcation, and Stiefenhofer [29] analyzes AGI substitution inside a CES production structure, where substitution is continuous across factors; our production structure is task-based, so

substitution occurs at task boundaries and the resulting instability is discrete.

7. Conclusion

This paper has built a task-based macroeconomic model of the AGI labor transition that integrates, in one numerically solvable system, the supply side (endogenous reinstatement collapse), the demand side (debt-deflation at the zero lower bound), the fiscal side (capital-tax financing of workfare and transfers), and a social-instability channel. Its results fall into three groups. On the *mechanism*, reinstatement collapse drives the labor share monotonically to zero with no self-correction, and the demand block turns that collapse into a decidable deflationary spiral rather than a shortfall (Theorems 1 and 4). On the *fiscal design*, a smooth-transition region exists with a Laffer interior capital tax (Propositions 6–7); public employment dominates transfers within the budget and protects better than the pure transfer against social-instability risk (Propositions 8–9); and the buffer family has a robustness ceiling beyond which only supply-side measures help (Proposition 10). On the *method*, Section 4 identifies the collapse as a boundary equilibrium bifurcation of the piecewise-smooth fast subsystem, giving a closed-form critical reinstatement rate, making that rate endogenous to public employment, workfare and retraining so that a strong, skill-retaining policy can carry the effective capture across the time-varying threshold, and characterizing the finite-rate lag between slow policy and fast employment.

The policy implications follow, within this calibrated model, rather than as universal claims. A smooth transition is not automatic: it requires an explicit policy buffer, and that buffer must be financed. Under the calibrated parameters and at the baseline frontier growth $g_A = 0.010$, the loss-minimizing design on the reported grid is workfare-dominant (a public-employment floor that converts relief recipients into dignified jobs), financed by a minimal sufficient capital tax, with transfers closed because their MPC leakage makes them costlier than workfare. We report the variant that retains a buffer rather than the marginally cheaper one that exhausts it, because the shock test of Section 5 shows that the buffer, not the last hundredth of loss, decides survival. Within this model, the pure transfer and no-policy regimes are infeasible: they violate the financing constraint and trigger the modeled social or economic collapse channels. The sufficiency of the design is conditional

on the pace of automation: at $g_A = 0.10$ the consumption floor is breached and the path crashes, so the buffer buys time rather than immunity. For sufficiently fast automation, no demand-side buffer within this model can suffice, so policy must reach the supply side: slowing displacement, strengthening the reinstatement engine, or steering the direction of technical change.

Six limitations point to future work. First, the social-instability channel is reduced-form; a microfoundation in dignity and acceptability (mapping relief to social pressure) would firm up Proposition 9. Second, the reinstatement rate ω and the automation-frontier growth g_A require sharper empirical calibration (the race between hardware-cost decline and reinstatement). Third, the model is closed-economy and does not model monetary policy beyond the zero lower bound; a monetary-fiscal interaction with active policy, and open-economy capital flows, are natural extensions. Fourth, the core model is deterministic. The frontier-growth shock experiment (Table 1) tests one margin and finds the headline configuration robust at innovations up to $\sigma = 0.03$ precisely because it carries a buffer, while the denser minimum-loss configuration loses most of its paths; demand-side, monetary and policy-implementation shocks are still absent, and a full stochastic version of the model is left to future work. Fifth, the social-instability parameters still lack strict direct external identification. No study offers a cutoff mappable to the normalized $[0, 1]$ stress variable; α_s is only partially anchored, since crime semi-elasticities reverse-engineer a range of 0.5–2.5 under the stated normalization and conversion assumptions, with the baseline 0.60 sitting at its conservative lower end; and $J = 10$ is a mean/upper-tail anchor drawn from crisis recovery and civil-war durations rather than an estimated exceedance window. The dedicated empirical-range sweep (Section 5.3) bounds the resulting fragility: the corner remains smooth at the baseline and across the lower range, turning to a social crash only when α_s exceeds 0.91 or ς^{th} falls below 0.33. The baseline values should therefore be read as conservative calibrations not rejected by the available evidence, not as externally estimated quantities, and the empirical samples underlying them (low-income African countries, European welfare states, and cross-country crisis episodes) differ institutionally from the modeled setting. Sixth, the boundary equilibrium bifurcation is a local analysis of the piecewise-smooth fast subsystem: the endogenous-reinstatement coefficients $\gamma_{PE}, \gamma_{TM}, \gamma_R$ are structural rather than

externally estimated, and the policy threshold p_E^* carries the same status as in Section 4.7—a dimensionless output of the calibrated model, illustrative rather than an empirical estimate—so a quantitative mapping from the analytic critical rate to the calibrated time path, including a microfoundation of the endogenous reinstatement law, is a calibration task left to future work.

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Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies in the writing process

During the preparation of this work the author used a generative AI assistant in order to improve the language and readability of the manuscript. After using this tool, the author reviewed and edited the content as needed and takes full responsibility for the content of the publication.

Data availability

The simulation code, parameter files and scripts that generate every reported number are publicly available at `https://github.com/whxhkwj/AGI-transition-workfare-UBI`.

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